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CYNC Brand Positioning & Website Experience Direction

A refined strategic foundation for how CYNC communicates, presents its expertise, and guides its website redesign.

For CYNC Architecture

Draft for Discussion
Version 2.0
September 2026

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Part I: Context and Strategic Understanding

1. Document Purpose

Establishing a Shared Strategic Foundation

This document has been prepared to establish a clear and shared strategic foundation for the next stage of the CYNC website redesign.

The work completed to date has created an opportunity to consider not only how CYNC should present its services and projects, but also how the website can more accurately communicate the firm's character, experience, approach, and value to clients.

Through the initial brand exploration, website concepts, CYNC's subsequent feedback, and the business and project materials shared during the engagement, a more complete understanding of the firm has emerged. This document brings those insights together and translates them into a unified direction for CYNC's brand expression and digital experience.

The objective is to ensure that the revised website reflects the qualities that already define CYNC while presenting them with greater clarity, consistency, and relevance to the clients and organizations the firm serves.

Clarifying the Website Narrative

The initial brand and website concepts established a useful visual and structural foundation. The review process then helped clarify the larger story the website needs to communicate.

CYNC's work cannot be represented through architectural imagery, service lists, and completed projects alone. While these elements remain important, they communicate only part of the value CYNC provides.

Clients may approach CYNC while facing questions involving existing or aging facilities, operational requirements, regulatory processes, budgets, schedules, stakeholder interests, consultant coordination, and long-term responsibilities. In these situations, clients require more than architectural design capability. They need an experienced partner who can help them understand the situation, evaluate the available options, coordinate the appropriate expertise, anticipate challenges, and make sound decisions.

The website should therefore communicate both what CYNC delivers and how CYNC helps clients move through complicated project environments with greater clarity and confidence.

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Projects will remain an important part of the website experience. Their role, however, should extend beyond visual presentation. Project stories should demonstrate CYNC's judgment, responsibilities, process, coordination, and contribution to the client's outcome.

This represents a shift from a primarily portfolio-led presentation toward a confidence-led experience supported by relevant evidence.

Connecting Strategy to Figma

Before the website design is revised, CYNC and Novus should share an agreed understanding of the firm's business, audiences, value, personality, and differentiators.

This document provides that foundation and translates it into practical direction for:

- CYNC's brand positioning and value proposition
- Values and operating principles
- Differentiators and supporting evidence
- Brand pillars
- Brand personality and tone of voice
- Key messaging
- Visual and imagery principles
- Website objectives and experience principles
- Sitemap and navigation
- Page purposes and content hierarchy
- Project-story structure
- Desktop and mobile design priorities
- Content and asset responsibilities
- Revision of the existing Figma direction

Once approved, this strategic direction will guide Novus in revising the agreed representative desktop and mobile website designs in Figma.

The Figma revision will establish the intended visual system, page hierarchy, content presentation, reusable design patterns, and representative templates for the core website experience. The work will demonstrate how final CYNC content and imagery should be presented within the future website.

Where final content is not yet available, representative text or placeholders may be used to demonstrate layout and hierarchy. Such material is provided for design purposes and should not be treated as final publication-ready website copy.

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Responsibilities and Scope

CYNC will provide the final written content, verified project information, biographies, credentials, service descriptions, contact information, photography, drawings, permissions, credits, and approvals required for public use.

Novus will apply the approved strategic direction and CYNC-supplied materials to the agreed Figma revision.

The current engagement does not include comprehensive website copywriting, project research, writing every project story, designing every future project or article page, website development, CMS implementation, content population, or ongoing publishing and maintenance. These activities may be addressed through a separate future engagement if required.

The additional strategic frameworks included in this document are intended to give CYNC a practical foundation for preparing future content and maintaining consistency as the website and project library evolve. They do not expand the current engagement into ongoing brand management, content production, or website administration.

Review and Confirmation

This document invites CYNC to review and confirm the proposed strategic direction before the Figma revision proceeds.

In particular, CYNC is asked to confirm that the document accurately represents:

- The situations and challenges that bring clients to CYNC
- The value clients receive from working with the firm
- CYNC's most meaningful differentiators
- The proposed positioning and value proposition
- The recommended values and brand pillars
- The desired brand personality and tone
- The role projects should play within the website
- The website objectives and recommended page structure
- The proposed visual and imagery direction
- The content and information CYNC will provide
- The scope and priorities of the Figma revision

Approval of this document will establish the strategic basis for Novus to refine the existing Figma designs within the current engagement.

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The intended result is a shared foundation that allows CYNC and Novus to move forward with a clear understanding of what the website should communicate, how the experience should feel, what information is required, and how the revised design will support CYNC's business.

2. Executive Summary

This document establishes the strategic direction for refining CYNC's brand expression and website experience. It brings together the feedback provided by CYNC, the business and project materials reviewed, and the lessons identified through the initial website design exploration.

The process has clarified that CYNC's value extends beyond the production of architectural designs. CYNC helps clients understand complicated building and facility challenges, identify the right path forward, coordinate the people and information required, and make responsible decisions with greater confidence.

CYNC's clients generally arrive with an expectation of architectural competence. What they need to determine is whether the firm understands the realities surrounding their project. These realities may include operational requirements, regulatory approvals, budgets, existing conditions, stakeholder interests, technical constraints, consultant coordination, and long-term responsibilities.

The recommended positioning therefore presents CYNC as an experienced, accountable architectural and Prime Consultant partner for organizations navigating complex building and facility decisions:

> CYNC helps organizations understand complex building and facility challenges, make sound decisions, and move forward with confidence through experienced architectural judgment, disciplined coordination, and accountable leadership.

This positioning shifts the website from a primarily portfolio-led presentation to a confidence-led experience. Projects remain important, but their role changes. Rather than serving mainly as visual showcases, project stories should provide evidence of how CYNC understands problems, exercises judgment, coordinates expertise, manages responsibilities, and creates practical long-term value.

Visitors should quickly understand that CYNC is grounded, straightforward, substantive, experienced, and personally engaged. The desired impression is not simply that CYNC produces attractive architecture. It is that CYNC understands complicated situations, knows which questions to ask, and can responsibly lead the work required to move a project forward.

The website should communicate this through four central brand pillars:

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1. Clarity Before Design
2. Judgment Grounded in Experience
3. Accountable Leadership and Coordination
4. Practical Outcomes Built for the Long Term

The visual direction should continue to use the restraint and contemporary architectural character established in the initial design. The existing palette, grid foundations, contrast, and selected responsive components provide a useful starting point. The next revision should place greater emphasis on clear hierarchy, legibility, authentic project context, people, process, technical information, and verified evidence. The experience should remain visually refined without depending on dramatic project photography or luxury-oriented language.

Within the current engagement, this direction will guide the revision of the agreed representative desktop and mobile designs in Figma. The design work will establish the appearance, hierarchy, content structure, and reusable templates for the core website experience. It does not require Novus to create a unique design for every future project or publication.

CYNC will provide the final publication-ready copy, verified project information, team details, approved imagery, permissions, credits, and other factual source material required for the designs. Comprehensive copywriting, content research, website development, CMS implementation, content population, and the creation of future project or Insights pages are outside the current engagement unless separately agreed in writing.

Approval of this document will provide Novus with the strategic foundation required to revise the existing Figma direction with greater accuracy and confidence. The intended outcome is a website design that reflects how CYNC actually works, communicates its value clearly, and gives prospective clients a strong reason to begin a conversation.

3. What We Heard

Architectural competence is expected

Architectural competence remains fundamental to CYNC's work, but it is generally assumed by the time a prospective client begins considering the firm.

Clients expect CYNC to understand design, technical requirements, regulatory processes, documentation, and construction. These capabilities establish professional credibility, but they do not fully explain why a client chooses to work with CYNC.

The more important consideration is whether CYNC can help the client understand the situation in front of them and determine how to move forward.

> Can these people help us figure this out?

This is the practical question the website must answer.

Clients often begin with a problem, not a defined project

CYNC's clients do not always arrive with a clearly defined scope or a predetermined solution.

They may be dealing with an aging facility, operational limitations, regulatory requirements, competing stakeholder interests, budget pressures, political considerations, or a schedule that cannot easily accommodate disruption. In many cases, the first requirement is not architectural design. It is understanding the nature of the problem and identifying the decisions that must be made.

Clients need help evaluating what is possible, what is necessary, what risks must be addressed, and which path represents the most responsible use of their resources.

CYNC's role begins by helping clients create clarity around these questions.

CYNC provides judgment and confidence

The value CYNC provides is closely connected to experienced judgment.

Clients rely on the firm to assess complex conditions, ask the right questions, identify risks, coordinate the appropriate expertise, and provide candid advice. This helps clients make informed decisions with a clearer understanding of the potential consequences.

The desired outcome is not simply a completed design. It is greater confidence throughout the process.

That confidence is created through:

- A clear understanding of the problem
- Realistic evaluation of available options
- Early identification of constraints and risks
- Appropriate coordination of consultants and specialists
- Responsible attention to budgets and schedules
- Consideration of operational and long-term requirements
- Direct and candid communication
- Accountability for moving the work forward

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Complexity must be managed, not hidden

Many CYNC engagements involve conditions that extend beyond the boundaries of conventional architectural design.

Approvals, regulations, existing facilities, technical systems, operations, budgets, stakeholder expectations, and specialist requirements may all influence the project. These considerations must be understood together rather than addressed independently.

CYNC helps clients navigate this complexity by creating structure around the process, coordinating the people involved, and supporting decisions at the appropriate time.

The website should communicate that CYNC is comfortable working in these environments. Complexity is not presented as an obstacle or used to make the firm appear more sophisticated. It is treated as a practical reality that must be understood and managed responsibly.

Projects are evidence of how CYNC works

CYNC's projects remain important, but their value is not limited to their visual appearance.

Some of the firm's most relevant work may not produce the kind of dramatic imagery commonly associated with architecture websites. Its significance may instead be found in the problem that was resolved, the constraints that were managed, the decisions that were supported, or the operational outcome that was achieved.

Projects should therefore provide evidence of:

- The situations CYNC has encountered
- The challenges the firm was asked to address
- The decisions and recommendations CYNC contributed
- The people and disciplines CYNC coordinated
- The risks and constraints that shaped the work
- The practical results achieved for the client
- The experience CYNC can bring to similar situations

The portfolio should support the CYNC story rather than become the entire story.

The firm's personality should feel authentic

CYNC should present itself with confidence, but without unnecessary performance or exaggeration.

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The firm's personality is grounded, straightforward, substantive, and quietly confident. Its professionalism comes from experience, judgment, and responsibility rather than grand claims or highly stylized language.

The website should feel:

- Experienced without appearing institutional
- Professional without feeling distant
- Confident without becoming self-important
- Creative without becoming theatrical
- Direct without becoming impersonal
- Substantive without becoming overly complicated
- Approachable without becoming casual

The overall presentation should reflect the character of a firm that understands the work, takes its responsibilities seriously, and communicates with clarity.

The desired impression

The website has a limited amount of time to establish confidence with a prospective client.

Its success should not be measured only by whether visitors consider it attractive or contemporary. It should be measured by whether visitors understand what CYNC brings to a difficult project and whether they feel confident beginning a conversation with the firm.

The intended impression is straightforward:

> These people know what they are doing.

Visitors should leave with the sense that CYNC will understand their situation, provide experienced guidance, coordinate the work responsibly, and help them make sound decisions.

4. Strategic Interpretation

CYNC provides clarity for consequential decisions

CYNC's value extends beyond the production of architectural designs and construction documents.

The firm helps clients understand complicated building and facility-related situations, determine what must be addressed, evaluate possible paths forward, and make responsible decisions. Architectural design is an important part of that work, but it is not always where the client's need begins.

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What CYNC fundamentally provides is experienced judgment applied to complex project conditions.

This judgment helps clients:

- Define the actual problem before committing to a solution
- Understand technical, operational, regulatory, and financial constraints
- Identify risks early
- Establish realistic priorities
- Assemble the appropriate expertise
- Coordinate stakeholders and specialists
- Evaluate options with greater confidence
- Move from uncertainty toward an actionable path

The strategic opportunity is to position CYNC as an experienced and accountable partner in the decision-making process, not simply as a provider of architectural services.

Traditional architectural positioning tells only part of the story

Architecture websites commonly lead with finished buildings, dramatic photography, design philosophy, awards, and broad claims about creativity or timelessness.

This approach can demonstrate aesthetic capability, but it does not fully communicate the reasons clients rely on CYNC.

It may also create an incomplete impression of the firm. A heavily image-led portfolio can suggest that visual design is CYNC's primary value or that the firm is principally focused on highly polished residential and commercial projects. This does not represent the full range of environments, responsibilities, and challenges reflected in CYNC's experience.

Many of the qualities that distinguish CYNC are not immediately visible in a completed-building photograph. Judgment, coordination, risk management, candid advice, operational understanding, and accountability must be communicated through narrative, evidence, and context.

The website must therefore show both architectural capability and the thinking that makes that capability valuable.

The narrative must move from output to contribution

The central website narrative should shift from what CYNC creates to how CYNC helps.

This does not mean minimizing architecture or removing projects. It means placing them within a more complete account of CYNC's role.

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The website should begin with the situations clients face and the value CYNC brings to those situations. Services and projects should then provide evidence of how the firm delivers that value.

The narrative should move:

- From buildings to client situations
- From aesthetics to judgment
- From broad service claims to specific forms of assistance
- From project categories to problems, decisions, and outcomes
- From visual impact to professional confidence
- From abstract design language to clear and substantive communication
- From demonstrating taste to demonstrating understanding
- From presenting CYNC as a studio to presenting CYNC as an accountable project partner

Visitors should understand not only that CYNC can design, but also that the firm can help determine what should be designed, why it is needed, how it can be delivered, and what must be considered along the way.

Imagery should provide context and evidence

The current visual direction relies heavily on dramatic architectural photography. This creates an attractive presentation, but it also makes the website dependent on a type of imagery that may not represent CYNC's most relevant work.

The revised imagery strategy should support the story rather than define it.

Completed-project photography should remain part of the website where strong and relevant images are available. It should be complemented by visual material that provides a broader understanding of CYNC's work, including:

- Existing facilities and site conditions
- Gordon and the CYNC team
- Client and consultant working sessions
- Site reviews and field observations
- Drawings, diagrams, plans, and technical studies
- Materials and building systems
- Construction progress
- Operational environments
- Before-and-after conditions
- Details that demonstrate practical problem solving
- Simple information graphics that explain process or complexity

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This approach allows CYNC to communicate meaningful experience even when a project is not visually dramatic.

Images should feel authentic, useful, and connected to the work. Generic stock photography, invented projects, and imagery selected primarily for visual prestige should not form the foundation of the final website.

The initial design provides a useful visual foundation

The initial website direction contains several qualities that can continue to support the refined strategy.

The restrained colour palette, structured layouts, generous use of space, and clear contrast between light and dark sections create a professional foundation. The design also contains useful modular patterns for presenting services, projects, team members, calls to action, and supporting information.

Elements that may be retained or further developed include:

- A restrained and confident visual palette
- Strong grid-based composition
- Clear typographic hierarchy
- Generous whitespace
- Simple navigation
- Modular content sections
- Direct calls to action
- Human presentation of the CYNC team
- A measured editorial quality
- Consistent desktop and mobile components

These elements should be refined to support clarity and credibility rather than architectural drama.

The contrast between sans serif and serif typography can remain a distinctive part of the visual language, but it should be used with restraint. The final experience should feel intelligent and considered without becoming fashionable, theatrical, or overly stylized.

The first impression must establish relevance and confidence

Within the first few seconds, a visitor should understand:

- Who CYNC helps
- The kinds of situations CYNC is equipped to address

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- What CYNC contributes beyond conventional architectural services
- Why the firm can be trusted with complex and consequential work
- How CYNC's experience benefits the client
- What the visitor should do next

The opening experience should not require visitors to interpret abstract design language or infer the firm's value from project imagery.

It should communicate a clear and credible proposition supported by evidence, professional restraint, and an understanding of the client's reality.

A prospective client should quickly recognize that CYNC is a firm capable of bringing clarity to complexity, guiding important decisions, coordinating the right expertise, and taking responsibility for helping a project move forward.

Strategic conclusion

The opportunity is not to make CYNC appear larger, louder, or more prestigious. It is to make the firm's actual value easier to understand.

The revised direction should present CYNC as an experienced, grounded, and accountable architectural practice that helps clients navigate complex building decisions with clarity and confidence.

Architecture remains central to the firm's expertise. The difference is that the website will communicate the judgment, leadership, and practical understanding behind the architecture, not only the final visual result.

Part II: Business and Brand Foundation

5. CYNC's Business Context

Architecture within complex project environments

CYNC is an architecture practice that operates in project environments where design decisions are closely connected to operational, technical, financial, regulatory, and organizational considerations.

The firm's work is not limited to producing a building design or a set of construction documents. CYNC helps clients understand existing conditions, define the problem accurately, evaluate

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available options, coordinate specialized expertise, and move toward an outcome that is practical, durable, and appropriate to the client's operating environment.

In many of these situations, the architectural answer cannot be separated from broader questions:

- What problem needs to be solved?
- What information must be confirmed before a solution is selected?
- How should limited resources be allocated?
- How will the project affect ongoing operations?
- Which technical disciplines and stakeholders must be coordinated?
- What risks could affect scope, schedule, cost, approvals, or construction?
- What solution will remain practical to operate and maintain over time?

CYNC's business context is therefore defined not only by the type of building involved, but also by the complexity surrounding the client's decision.

Types of engagements CYNC handles

The materials reviewed indicate that CYNC is equipped to lead and support engagements across multiple stages of the project lifecycle.

These engagements may include:

- Existing-condition investigation and project definition
- Feasibility studies and options analysis
- Lifecycle renewal and facility improvement planning
- Prime consulting and multidisciplinary project leadership
- Architectural design and technical coordination
- Renovations, upgrades, and adaptations to existing facilities
- Tender documentation and procurement support
- Construction administration and consultant coordination
- Project close-out and transition into operation

Some engagements begin with a clearly defined architectural scope. Others begin with an operational concern, aging infrastructure, an unresolved technical condition, or a need to determine the most appropriate course of action.

The City of Calgary Fire Training Academy Water Reuse submission illustrates the second type of situation. CYNC's proposed approach did not begin with a predetermined treatment solution. It began with investigation, performance assessment, confirmation of requirements, and evaluation of available options before proceeding into detailed design.

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This approach reflects an important aspect of CYNC's work. The firm does not assume that design should begin before the underlying problem and performance requirements are properly understood.

Sectors and organizational environments

CYNC's stated and demonstrated experience includes work within:

- Municipal and public-sector environments
- Institutional and educational facilities
- Parks and public recreation facilities
- Healthcare environments
- Industrial and technically specialized facilities
- Commercial and residential development
- Projects undertaken for private owners and developers

The sectors vary, but the organizational environments frequently share similar characteristics. Clients may be accountable to public authorities, boards, internal departments, operators, funding requirements, procurement policies, or multiple stakeholder groups.

These environments often require:

- Responsible management of public or organizational funds
- Clear documentation and decision-making
- Coordination among internal and external stakeholders
- Compliance with formal procurement and approval processes
- Sensitivity to operational and public-service requirements
- Consideration of long-term maintenance and lifecycle costs
- Transparent management of project scope, schedule, and budget

The completed Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades project provides a relevant example. The work involved the renewal of five existing buildings within a provincial park environment, together with considerations related to public access, seasonal operations, safety, maintainability, and supporting site improvements.

This is representative of the wider context in which CYNC creates value. The physical design is important, but it must succeed within the operational realities of the organization and the facility.

The nature of project complexity

The complexity of CYNC's engagements is not defined by building size alone. A relatively contained project may still involve significant technical, operational, or organizational challenges.

The project materials identify conditions such as:

- Aging buildings, systems, and infrastructure
- Incomplete or uncertain information about existing conditions
- Facilities that must remain operational during assessment or construction
- Restricted budgets and funding limitations
- Compressed or seasonally dependent schedules
- Multiple technical disciplines with interdependent responsibilities
- Regulatory, permitting, and approval requirements
- Public procurement and tendering processes
- Specialized environmental or site conditions
- Requirements for durability, maintainability, and long-term performance
- The need to reconcile immediate priorities with lifecycle value

The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission demonstrates how these conditions can overlap. The proposed assignment involved an operating public facility in a non-urban park environment, with mechanical and controls requirements, building-envelope considerations, wildlife intrusion, construction phasing, cost control, procurement, and long-term maintainability all forming part of the project context.

The architectural response must therefore integrate several forms of information and expertise. The challenge is not simply to develop an appealing design. It is to establish a coordinated and executable path from the client's current situation to an appropriate outcome.

CYNC's role within the wider project team

CYNC frequently positions itself as the Prime Consultant and Project Lead.

In this role, the firm provides a central point of accountability between the client and the wider consultant team. Depending on the project, that team may include mechanical, electrical, structural, civil, cost, environmental, controls, wildlife, process, or other specialized consultants.

CYNC's role is to ensure that these individual areas of expertise contribute to one coordinated project outcome.

This responsibility may include:

- Acting as the primary client contact
- Establishing a shared understanding of the project objectives

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- Coordinating the work of specialist consultants
- Integrating technical recommendations into the architectural response
- Managing communication, scope, schedule, and deliverables
- Monitoring alignment with the approved budget
- Coordinating tender and procurement documentation
- Supporting the client through construction and close-out
- Maintaining continuity as decisions move from one project stage to the next

Direct principal involvement is an important part of this structure. Gordon Murray's role is presented as active project leadership rather than distant executive oversight. This gives the client access to senior judgment throughout the engagement and supports continuity across client communication, consultant coordination, documentation, and construction administration.

CYNC does not need to replace the expertise of every specialist involved. Its value lies in understanding how the disciplines relate, asking the necessary questions, identifying gaps or conflicts, and keeping the team focused on the client's larger objective.

Architectural output and business value

The tangible outputs of CYNC's work may include:

- Assessments and recommendations
- Feasibility and options studies
- Architectural designs
- Coordinated technical documentation
- Cost and procurement information
- Tender packages
- Construction administration
- Project close-out documentation

These outputs are essential, but they are not the complete value that the client receives.

The broader business value lies in helping clients:

- Define the right problem before committing to a solution
- Make informed decisions based on verified conditions
- Understand the implications of available options
- Manage uncertainty and project risk
- Coordinate multiple disciplines and stakeholders
- Avoid premature decisions that may lead to redesign or unnecessary cost
- Balance immediate requirements with long-term operational needs
- Protect project intent through procurement and construction

- Arrive at an outcome that is practical to build, operate, and maintain

This distinction is central to understanding CYNC's business.

Architectural design is the professional service through which much of the work is delivered. The deeper value is the judgment, coordination, clarity, and accountability that CYNC brings to the client's project.

The business context in one statement

CYNC helps organizations navigate complex building and facility decisions by combining architectural expertise with direct leadership, disciplined coordination, and practical judgment.

The result is not only an architectural solution. It is a clearer and more manageable path from an uncertain or demanding project situation to an informed, coordinated, and durable outcome.

6. Priority Audiences

Defining the audiences CYNC must reach

CYNC works with clients across several sectors, but the people evaluating the firm often face a similar decision.

They are responsible for a project with competing requirements, incomplete information, multiple stakeholders, and meaningful consequences if the wrong decisions are made. They are not simply selecting an architectural style. They are selecting a professional partner they can trust to understand the situation, coordinate the necessary expertise, and guide the project responsibly.

The following audience framework is based on CYNC's stated experience, the project submissions reviewed, and the client situations described throughout the brand discovery process.

It is intended to guide website messaging and content architecture. It does not suggest that every audience should receive a completely separate brand message. Instead, it identifies the concerns CYNC must address while maintaining one coherent position.

The available materials suggest that CYNC's strongest narrative foundation is in public-sector, institutional, and technically demanding project environments. Work for developers and private property owners remains relevant, but should be presented through the same emphasis on judgment, coordination, and dependable delivery.

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The commercial priority of these audiences should ultimately be confirmed against CYNC's current business development objectives, project pipeline, and desired future work.

Municipalities

Municipal clients are responsible for facilities and infrastructure that must serve the public while operating within formal budgets, approval processes, and procurement requirements.

Situations they face

Municipal projects may involve:

- Aging buildings, systems, or infrastructure
- Facilities requiring renovation, renewal, or adaptation
- Operational problems that do not yet have a clearly defined solution
- Capital improvements subject to public procurement requirements
- Projects involving several municipal departments and external consultants
- Facilities that must remain partially or fully operational
- Decisions requiring council, administrative, regulatory, or stakeholder approval

Concerns and pressures

Municipal decision-makers must balance public value, operational requirements, available funding, schedule commitments, and accountability to multiple stakeholders.

They may be concerned about:

- Committing funds before the problem is sufficiently understood
- Incomplete information about existing conditions
- Changes to scope or cost after approvals have been obtained
- Coordination failures between consultants
- Procurement and tendering complications
- Disruption to public services or facility operations
- Whether the proposed solution will be durable and maintainable
- The ability to explain and defend project decisions internally and publicly

What they need from an architectural partner

Municipal clients need a partner who can establish a clear process, coordinate technical contributors, document decisions, and maintain alignment among scope, budget, operations, and public responsibilities.

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They need an architect who understands that the best initial response may be further investigation and options analysis rather than immediate commitment to a predetermined design.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by evidence of:

- Public-sector project experience
- Familiarity with formal procurement and tendering
- Clear prime consultant accountability
- Disciplined investigation and options evaluation
- Coordination of multidisciplinary consultant teams
- Direct senior involvement
- Practical consideration of operations and maintainability
- Clear reporting, recommendations, and decision points

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

Municipal visitors may hesitate if the website:

- Appears primarily focused on residential or image-led architecture
- Does not demonstrate familiarity with public procurement
- Provides insufficient evidence of multidisciplinary coordination
- Does not explain CYNC's capacity to lead technically complex assignments
- Focuses on completed buildings without explaining the problems addressed
- Makes it difficult to identify relevant public-sector experience

School boards and educational organizations

School boards manage facilities that must support learning, safety, accessibility, and long-term operational needs within structured budgets and approval environments.

Situations they face

Educational facility projects may involve:

- Renovations or additions to occupied schools
- Modular classroom programs and capacity requirements
- Aging facilities requiring phased renewal
- Multiple projects delivered across different sites
- Schedule constraints tied to the academic calendar
- Coordination with facilities teams, administrators, consultants, and contractors
- Standardization requirements across a broader building portfolio

Concerns and pressures

School boards may be managing:

- Limited capital and maintenance budgets
- Strict construction windows
- Student and staff safety
- Disruption to teaching and facility operations
- Consistency across multiple sites
- Accessibility and regulatory requirements
- Community and stakeholder expectations
- The long-term cost of operating and maintaining facilities

What they need from an architectural partner

Educational clients need an architectural partner who can work within established procedures, understand occupied environments, coordinate multiple stakeholders, and develop solutions that are practical across both the individual project and the broader facility portfolio.

They also need responsive communication and reliable documentation, particularly when several projects or sites are moving forward concurrently.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by evidence of:

- Experience with educational organizations
- Work involving multiple sites or repeatable programs
- Understanding of occupied-facility constraints
- Realistic planning around school calendars and construction periods
- Clear coordination and documentation practices
- Direct access to responsible project leadership
- Attention to safety, durability, accessibility, and maintenance
- Consistent support through tendering and construction

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

School board decision-makers may hesitate if the website:

- Does not show recognizable educational or institutional experience
- Emphasizes visual originality without discussing operational practicality
- Provides little information about occupied-building work
- Does not demonstrate the ability to manage multiple stakeholders or sites
- Leaves uncertainty about project leadership and delivery capacity

Healthcare organizations

Healthcare facilities operate within environments where safety, continuity, technical coordination, and responsible decision-making are particularly important.

Situations they face

Healthcare organizations may require:

- Renovations or upgrades within operating facilities
- Renewal of aging building systems
- Adaptation of existing spaces to new operational requirements
- Coordination among facilities, clinical, technical, and administrative stakeholders
- Projects involving specialized engineering and regulatory considerations
- Phased work intended to reduce disruption to ongoing services

Concerns and pressures

Healthcare decision-makers may be concerned about:

- Maintaining safe and uninterrupted operations
- The effect of construction on patients, staff, and facility users
- Technical coordination among building systems
- Regulatory and approval requirements
- Infection prevention, safety, accessibility, and operational protocols
- Budget accountability and lifecycle cost
- The consequences of incomplete documentation or poorly coordinated work

What they need from an architectural partner

Healthcare organizations need a careful and disciplined architectural partner who listens to operational stakeholders, respects the conditions of the facility, coordinates specialist expertise, and recognizes that design decisions can affect service delivery.

They require clear communication, structured decision-making, and a strong understanding of the relationship between the physical environment and ongoing operations.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by:

- Relevant and verifiable healthcare or institutional experience
- Evidence of work within operating facilities
- Strong multidisciplinary coordination
- Clear quality-management practices

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- Direct senior oversight
- Respect for safety, compliance, and operational continuity
- Practical documentation and construction-phase support

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

Healthcare organizations may hesitate if the website:

- Makes broad healthcare claims without supporting evidence
- Does not communicate an understanding of operational sensitivity
- Presents architecture primarily as an aesthetic exercise
- Provides insufficient information about technical coordination
- Does not clarify CYNC's role, project process, or senior involvement

Healthcare-related statements and examples on the website should therefore be specific, accurate, and supported by confirmed experience.

Public agencies

Public agencies include provincial authorities, park organizations, boards, and other publicly accountable entities responsible for facilities, programs, or public assets.

Their projects may share characteristics with municipal work, but they can also involve specialized mandates, remote locations, environmental conditions, seasonal operations, or agency-specific procurement requirements.

Situations they face

Public agencies may be dealing with:

- Existing facilities requiring lifecycle renewal
- Public buildings located in remote or non-urban environments
- Projects affected by environmental or seasonal conditions
- Facilities that must continue supporting public programs and services
- Specialized technical or operational concerns
- Formal qualification, procurement, and reporting processes
- Multiple internal departments, consultants, and approval authorities

Concerns and pressures

These organizations may need to manage:

- Stewardship of public funds and assets
- Long-term facility performance

- Operational and seasonal limitations
- Environmental and site-specific risks
- Public safety and accessibility
- Consultant accountability
- Construction coordination in locations with limited access
- Transparent and defensible decision-making

What they need from an architectural partner

Public agencies need a partner who can understand their mandate, work within established procurement structures, coordinate the required specialist disciplines, and develop solutions suited to the actual operating environment.

They need recommendations that are technically sound, financially responsible, and maintainable by the organization after construction is complete.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by:

- Completed public-sector and park-related experience
- Evidence of work involving existing facilities
- An approach tailored to project-specific risks
- Clear consultant roles and accountability
- Cost review at meaningful decision points
- Understanding of operational and seasonal constraints
- Direct principal involvement
- Support from investigation through construction and close-out

The Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades project provides relevant evidence of CYNC's ability to work within a public recreation and provincial park context involving multiple existing buildings, public access, seasonal operations, safety, and maintainability.

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

Public agencies may hesitate if the website:

- Does not make public-sector experience easy to identify
- Provides images without explaining operational or technical outcomes
- Does not communicate familiarity with qualification and procurement processes
- Leaves questions about multidisciplinary team leadership
- Does not demonstrate how CYNC responds to unusual site or operating conditions

Industrial organizations

Industrial and technically specialized organizations require architectural work to function within operational systems, production requirements, safety expectations, and engineering-led project environments.

Situations they face

Industrial clients may require:

- New or adapted operational facilities
- Upgrades to existing technical buildings
- Integration of architectural and engineering systems
- Work within active production or operational environments
- Projects with specialized equipment or performance requirements
- Facility changes driven by capacity, safety, process, or regulatory needs

Concerns and pressures

Industrial decision-makers may be concerned about:

- Operational interruption or lost productivity
- Safety and regulatory compliance
- Coordination between architecture, engineering, equipment, and process requirements
- Constructability within an active facility
- Schedule certainty and implementation sequencing
- Long-term durability and maintenance
- Whether the architect understands that operations take priority over appearance

What they need from an architectural partner

Industrial organizations need an architectural partner who is comfortable working alongside engineers, operators, technical consultants, and contractors.

They need someone who can understand how architectural decisions interact with equipment, workflows, building systems, safety requirements, and future maintenance.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by evidence of:

- Experience in industrial or technically specialized environments
- Effective coordination with engineering disciplines
- An ability to understand operational requirements
- Clear documentation and constructability awareness
- Practical problem-solving

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- Responsiveness during construction
- Senior leadership that can identify risks and support timely decisions

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

Industrial clients may hesitate if the website:

- Looks primarily residential, decorative, or lifestyle-oriented
- Does not show technically relevant project experience
- Uses language that prioritizes artistic expression over operations
- Does not explain CYNC's approach to engineering coordination
- Provides little evidence of practical delivery or construction support

Developers and property owners

Developers and private property owners operate in a commercial environment where design quality must align with feasibility, approvals, market expectations, schedule, and long-term asset performance.

Situations they face

These clients may be considering:

- New development opportunities
- Renovation or repositioning of an existing property
- Residential or mixed-use projects
- Feasibility questions before significant capital is committed
- Municipal planning and approval requirements
- Coordination among investors, operators, consultants, contractors, and authorities
- Decisions affecting both immediate construction cost and long-term asset value

Concerns and pressures

Developers and owners may be managing:

- Project feasibility and return on investment
- Approval timelines
- Construction budgets and financing requirements
- Market expectations
- Design quality and differentiation
- Schedule risk
- Consultant responsiveness
- Long-term durability, operation, and asset value

What they need from an architectural partner

Developers and owners need a partner who can combine design judgment with commercial awareness.

They need clear advice, early identification of risks, effective consultant coordination, and a design process that remains connected to approvals, cost, constructability, market needs, and long-term performance.

What builds confidence

Confidence is strengthened by:

- Relevant development and property experience
- Clear understanding of approval and permitting processes
- Evidence of design quality supported by practical thinking
- Responsiveness and direct access to senior leadership
- Early identification of constraints and opportunities
- Coordination of the broader consultant team
- An ability to maintain design intent through construction

What may prevent them from contacting CYNC

Developers and owners may hesitate if the website:

- Does not demonstrate commercial or development awareness
- Presents attractive projects without explaining the client objective
- Provides no indication of how CYNC approaches cost, approvals, or risk
- Makes the firm appear focused only on public-sector assignments
- Does not provide a clear path for discussing an early-stage opportunity

Shared audience expectations

Although the audiences differ, their expectations converge around several common needs.

They want an architectural partner who:

- Understands the wider situation, not only the building
- Asks the right questions before recommending a solution
- Provides direct and candid professional advice
- Coordinates people, information, and technical disciplines
- Recognizes budget, schedule, operational, and approval pressures
- Maintains accountability across the project lifecycle
- Produces clear, practical, and durable outcomes

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The website should therefore avoid presenting CYNC as several different firms for several different sectors. Its role is to communicate one consistent promise that remains relevant across these audiences:

CYNC brings clarity, coordination, and experienced judgment to projects where the decisions matter.

Sector-specific projects, experience, and evidence can then demonstrate how that promise applies within each audience's environment.

7. Brand Positioning

The role of positioning

Brand positioning defines the place CYNC should occupy in the minds of prospective clients. It clarifies what the firm does, who it serves, why its approach matters, and what makes it a credible choice.

CYNC should not be positioned only as a firm that produces attractive architecture. Architectural competence and design quality remain essential, but clients often assume those capabilities when evaluating a qualified architectural practice.

The stronger opportunity is to communicate what clients may not immediately see in a project image: the judgment, leadership, coordination, and accountability required to move a complex project forward successfully.

The recommended positioning is therefore centred on CYNC's ability to understand complicated project situations, establish clear direction, coordinate the appropriate expertise, and help clients make sound decisions with confidence.

Brand essence

Clarity to move forward.

This is the simplest expression of the value CYNC brings to its clients.

Projects may begin with uncertainty, competing priorities, incomplete information, or a problem that has not yet been properly defined. CYNC helps the client understand what matters, identify an appropriate course of action, and proceed with greater confidence.

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The brand essence is an internal strategic anchor. It is not necessarily a proposed public-facing tagline. Its purpose is to guide messaging, design decisions, project storytelling, and the overall website experience.

Everything presented through the CYNC brand should reinforce at least one part of this idea:

- CYNC brings clarity to complicated situations.
- CYNC creates an informed path forward.
- CYNC gives clients confidence in the decisions being made.

Market role

CYNC's market role can be defined as:

An architectural advisor, Prime Consultant, and accountable project leader for organizations and owners navigating complex building and facility decisions.

This role places CYNC between two incomplete perceptions of an architecture firm.

At one end is the perception of the architect primarily as a designer of visually distinctive buildings. At the other is the perception of a technical service provider responsible mainly for drawings and documentation.

CYNC's role encompasses both design and technical delivery, but extends beyond them. The firm helps define the problem, advises the client, coordinates specialist expertise, integrates competing requirements, and maintains continuity across the project lifecycle.

CYNC remains clearly and credibly an architecture practice. Its distinguishing value is how it applies architectural expertise within the wider business, operational, technical, and organizational context of the project.

Recommended positioning statement

For organizations and owners facing complex building and facility decisions, CYNC is an architecture and prime consulting practice that brings experienced judgment, disciplined coordination, and direct accountability to the project. By understanding the problem before prescribing the solution and leading the appropriate expertise through delivery, CYNC helps clients make sound decisions and move forward with confidence.

This statement is intended to serve as the strategic foundation for the brand. It does not need to appear on the website exactly as written.

Its role is to ensure that the website, company descriptions, project narratives, service language, and business development materials communicate the same fundamental position.

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Core value proposition

CYNC turns complex project conditions into a clear, coordinated, and achievable path forward.

This value is created through four connected contributions.

Understand the whole situation

CYNC begins by understanding the client's objectives, existing conditions, operational requirements, constraints, stakeholders, and definition of success.

The firm does not isolate the architectural assignment from the larger context in which the project must function.

Establish clear direction

CYNC helps define the actual problem, identify decision criteria, assess available options, and recommend an appropriate course of action.

This reduces the likelihood of committing too early to a solution that has not been sufficiently investigated.

Coordinate the right expertise

CYNC assembles and leads the disciplines required for the project. It provides a clear point of accountability while ensuring that specialist recommendations contribute to one integrated outcome.

Carry decisions through delivery

CYNC maintains continuity as the work progresses through design, documentation, procurement, construction, and close-out.

This helps protect the reasoning and objectives behind earlier decisions as the project moves into more detailed and demanding stages.

Brand promise

CYNC brings experienced judgment, clear advice, and accountable leadership to every stage of the project, helping clients understand what matters and make informed decisions.

This promise is deliberately practical.

It does not guarantee that every project will be free from change, risk, or unexpected conditions. Such a guarantee would not be credible within complex building projects.

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Instead, it promises how CYNC will participate:

- The firm will seek to understand before recommending.
- It will communicate directly and candidly.
- It will identify and coordinate the expertise the project requires.
- It will consider the client's operational and organizational realities.
- It will maintain accountability for the integrated project response.
- It will help the client make decisions with better information and clearer direction.

One-sentence company description

CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice that helps organizations navigate complex building and facility projects through experienced leadership, clear advice, and disciplined coordination.

This description is suitable for concise applications such as website introductions, proposal profiles, social media profiles, directory listings, and introductory communications.

Longer company description

CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice serving public-sector, institutional, industrial, development, and private clients. The firm helps organizations understand complex building and facility challenges, evaluate the available options, and establish a practical path from initial investigation through design and delivery.

Working as an architectural lead and Prime Consultant, CYNC coordinates the technical disciplines, stakeholders, approvals, budgets, schedules, and operational requirements that influence a project. Through direct senior involvement, clear communication, and disciplined project leadership, CYNC helps clients make informed decisions and achieve solutions that are purposeful, coordinated, durable, and appropriate to their environment.

This description can be adapted for the About page, proposals, qualifications packages, and other business development materials.

Desired client perception

The desired response to the CYNC brand is not limited to:

> "They design attractive buildings."

The more important response is:

> **"They understand complex projects, they will give us sound advice, and they know how to move the work forward."**

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Prospective clients should come away with the following impressions:

- CYNC understands the wider situation surrounding the project.
- CYNC asks the necessary questions before recommending a solution.
- CYNC provides experienced and candid professional advice.
- CYNC can lead and coordinate a multidisciplinary team.
- CYNC recognizes the importance of budget, schedule, operations, approvals, and lifecycle performance.
- CYNC provides direct access to senior project leadership.
- CYNC is practical without being conventional or uncreative.
- CYNC is design-conscious without being driven by visual novelty.
- CYNC is responsive, accountable, and dependable.
- CYNC can be trusted with projects where the decisions carry meaningful consequences.

The brand should feel grounded, straightforward, substantive, and quietly confident.

It should not need exaggerated language or claims of exceptionalism. Confidence should come from the clarity of CYNC's thinking, the relevance of its experience, and the evidence provided through its work.

Positioning boundaries

A clear positioning strategy also establishes what CYNC should avoid communicating.

CYNC is not only a portfolio of buildings

Projects are important evidence, but images alone cannot communicate CYNC's full contribution. Project stories should explain the client's situation, the complexity involved, CYNC's role, the decisions made, and the outcome achieved.

CYNC is not a general management consultancy

The positioning should not separate CYNC from architecture. Its judgment and leadership are valuable because they are grounded in architectural knowledge, project delivery experience, and an understanding of buildings and facilities.

CYNC is not defined by one visual style

The firm's value does not depend on producing projects with a uniform architectural appearance. Intentional design means responding appropriately to the client, context, operation, budget, and purpose of each project.

CYNC does not need to claim every area of expertise internally

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As Prime Consultant, CYNC's strength includes recognizing when specialist expertise is required, assembling the appropriate team, and coordinating those disciplines around the client's objectives.

CYNC should not present complexity as complication

The brand should not make the process feel academic, bureaucratic, or unnecessarily elaborate. CYNC's role is to make complexity more understandable and manageable for the client.

CYNC should not compete through exaggerated confidence

The tone should be assured but measured. Claims should be supported by demonstrated experience, clear explanations, and relevant evidence.

Recommended positioning territory

The recommended positioning can be summarized as follows:

CYNC helps organizations understand complex building and facility challenges, make sound decisions, and move forward with confidence through experienced architectural judgment, disciplined coordination, and accountable leadership.

This territory provides sufficient flexibility for CYNC's different sectors and project types while maintaining one recognizable market position.

It allows the website to communicate architectural capability, project leadership, technical coordination, and practical business value without reducing CYNC to any one service, sector, or design style.

8. Values and Operating Principles

Values expressed through behaviour

Values are meaningful only when they influence how a firm thinks, communicates, makes decisions, and carries out its responsibilities.

The proposed CYNC values are therefore framed as operating principles. They describe behaviours already evident in CYNC's project approach and establish expectations that clients, consultants, and project partners should be able to observe.

These principles should guide:

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- How CYNC advises clients
- How decisions are evaluated
- How risks and uncertainties are communicated
- How consultant teams are coordinated
- How client resources are managed
- How CYNC represents itself through proposals, project stories, and the website

The recommended framework consists of six connected principles.

1. Candour

Say what needs to be said, clearly and respectfully.

Clients depend on CYNC for professional judgment, not simply agreement or reassurance. Candour means communicating honestly about project conditions, available options, risks, limitations, costs, and consequences.

It also means acknowledging when information is incomplete, when further investigation is required, or when a proposed direction may not serve the client's best interests.

In practice, candour means:

- Asking difficult but necessary questions
- Identifying uncertainty rather than concealing it
- Communicating potential risks early
- Explaining the implications of different options
- Providing a clear professional recommendation
- Distinguishing verified information from assumptions
- Advising against a direction when the evidence does not support it
- Keeping clients informed when circumstances change

Candour does not mean being inflexible or unnecessarily critical. It means giving the client the information and professional perspective required to make an informed decision.

2. Accountability

Take ownership of the work and follow it through.

Complex projects involve multiple participants, but the client should not be left to resolve gaps between individual responsibilities.

As Prime Consultant and Project Lead, CYNC provides a clear point of accountability. The firm takes responsibility for coordinating the overall project response, maintaining communication, and ensuring that decisions and deliverables remain connected to the client's objectives.

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In practice, accountability means:

- Establishing clear roles and responsibilities
- Serving as the primary point of contact
- Coordinating the work of specialist consultants
- Monitoring scope, schedule, budget, and deliverables
- Following up on unresolved questions and decisions
- Identifying coordination gaps before they become larger problems
- Maintaining continuity from one project stage to the next
- Remaining engaged through procurement, construction, and close-out
- Taking responsibility for the integrated quality of the work

Accountability does not mean that CYNC performs every specialist function. It means CYNC understands who is responsible, how the work connects, and what must happen to keep the project moving toward a coordinated outcome.

3. Practical Judgment

Find the right response for the actual situation.

Every project has a different combination of objectives, limitations, operating conditions, stakeholders, and risks. CYNC's role is not to impose a predetermined answer. It is to understand the specific situation and apply experience to determine an appropriate path forward.

Practical judgment combines analysis with experience. It considers what is technically possible, operationally appropriate, financially responsible, and realistically deliverable.

In practice, practical judgment means:

- Understanding the problem before recommending a solution
- Investigating existing conditions where necessary
- Establishing clear criteria for evaluating options
- Balancing design quality with budget, operations, schedule, and maintainability
- Recognizing when additional specialist advice is required
- Avoiding unnecessary complexity
- Recommending solutions appropriate to the client's circumstances
- Considering implementation and constructability during design
- Knowing when sufficient information exists to make a decision

Practical does not mean ordinary or unambitious. It means that creativity is applied with purpose and that the recommended solution can succeed within the conditions of the project.

4. Stewardship

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Treat the client's resources, facilities, and responsibilities with care.

CYNC's clients often manage significant physical assets, constrained budgets, public funds, operational facilities, or environments that must remain useful for many years.

Stewardship means recognizing that project decisions affect more than the immediate design. They can influence capital cost, operational continuity, maintenance requirements, lifecycle performance, public value, and the long-term usefulness of the facility.

In practice, stewardship means:

- Respecting the client's budget and decision-making authority
- Considering lifecycle value rather than initial cost alone
- Protecting existing assets where appropriate
- Evaluating durability and maintainability
- Considering the effect of construction on ongoing operations
- Avoiding premature commitments that may lead to unnecessary cost
- Supporting transparent and defensible decisions
- Using time, information, and specialist resources responsibly
- Designing with long-term use and performance in mind

Stewardship does not mean selecting the least expensive option in every situation. It means helping the client understand the relationship between cost, risk, performance, and long-term value.

5. Coordinated Collaboration

Bring the right people together around one project objective.

Complex projects require contributions from clients, users, operators, authorities, engineers, cost consultants, specialist advisors, contractors, and other stakeholders.

Collaboration becomes valuable when those contributions are organized, responsibilities are clear, and different areas of expertise are integrated into a coherent response.

CYNC's role is to create that coordination while keeping the client's objectives at the centre of the work.

In practice, coordinated collaboration means:

- Listening carefully to clients, users, and operational stakeholders
- Assembling a consultant team suited to the project's specific requirements
- Defining how individual disciplines contribute to the overall outcome
- Creating clear communication and decision-making channels

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- Identifying conflicts and interdependencies between disciplines
- Reviewing specialist recommendations within the wider project context
- Encouraging direct and constructive discussion
- Maintaining alignment as decisions evolve
- Documenting responsibilities, decisions, and next steps

Collaboration does not mean avoiding leadership or seeking consensus on every question. Effective collaboration requires someone to maintain direction, resolve uncertainty, and keep the team accountable to the project.

6. Purposeful Thoroughness

Examine what matters and document it properly.

Thoroughness is particularly important when projects involve existing buildings, uncertain conditions, technical dependencies, formal approvals, or significant operational consequences.

CYNC's approach should provide enough investigation, coordination, and documentation to support confident decisions without introducing unnecessary process.

In practice, purposeful thoroughness means:

- Reviewing available information before establishing direction
- Confirming critical assumptions
- Investigating existing conditions when they may affect the solution
- Identifying missing information and unresolved dependencies
- Coordinating documentation across disciplines
- Reviewing work at meaningful project stages
- Maintaining clear records of decisions and recommendations
- Preparing documentation appropriate for procurement and construction
- Following details through to implementation and close-out

Thoroughness does not mean studying every possibility indefinitely. It means understanding which questions materially affect the outcome and resolving them before they become costly or disruptive.

How the principles work together

These principles are not independent promises. They describe one connected way of working.

CYNC begins by examining the project with **purposeful thoroughness** and applying **practical judgment** to the information available. It communicates its advice with **candour**, treats the client's resources with **stewardship**, organizes the necessary expertise through **coordinated collaboration**, and maintains **accountability** for carrying the work forward.

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Together, these principles support the central expectation CYNC wants to establish:

> **CYNC will understand the situation, provide clear advice, coordinate the right people, and take responsibility for moving the project forward.**

This is how the brand should communicate confidence. Not through exaggerated claims, but through a clear and credible explanation of how CYNC works.

9. Differentiators and Reasons to Believe

Differentiation must be supported by evidence

A differentiator is not simply a positive statement about the firm. It must identify something relevant to the client, meaningfully distinguish CYNC's approach, and be supported by credible evidence.

No single differentiator defines CYNC on its own. The strength of the position comes from the combination of experienced principal leadership, thoughtful problem definition, coordinated delivery, and responsibility for the complete project response.

The supporting evidence should be understood in four categories:

1. **Completed project experience:** Evidence of work CYNC has delivered.
2. **Current project experience:** Active assignments demonstrating CYNC's present responsibilities and capabilities.
3. **Leadership history and credentials:** Experience Gordon and other team members bring to CYNC.
4. **Proposed project approach:** Evidence of how CYNC thinks, structures teams, and intends to deliver an assignment. A proposal demonstrates methodology and understanding, but should not be presented as completed project experience.

This distinction should be maintained in all future website and business development content.

1. Direct principal involvement

Clients work directly with experienced leadership throughout the project.

In some firms, senior leadership is highly visible during business development but becomes less involved after the project begins. CYNC presents a different model. Gordon remains directly involved as the client contact, architectural leader, Prime Consultant, and senior reviewer.

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This provides greater continuity between the original project objectives, the advice being provided, the work of the consultant team, and the decisions made during delivery.

Why it matters

Complex projects require judgment that cannot always be transferred through layers of communication. Direct principal involvement gives clients access to someone with the authority and experience to provide advice, resolve uncertainty, and maintain accountability.

Reasons to believe

- Gordon is identified as Founder and Principal of CYNC Architecture.
- He holds the professional designations AAA, AIBC, SAA, and FRAIC.
- CYNC's project submissions identify Gordon as Principal-in-Charge, Project Lead, senior client contact, and Prime Consultant lead.
- In the Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission, Gordon is named as the primary client contact responsible for consultant coordination, communication, schedule management, architectural and envelope coordination, tender documentation, and construction administration.
- The same submission identifies direct principal involvement as an organizational advantage offered by CYNC.

2. Experienced judgment

CYNC brings senior architectural judgment to decisions that extend beyond design alone.

Experience becomes valuable when it improves the quality of decisions. CYNC's leadership experience spans client strategy, consultant coordination, technical review, quality assurance, project delivery, and construction-phase support.

This allows the firm to recognize dependencies, identify questions that must be resolved, and understand how early decisions may affect later stages of the project.

Why it matters

Clients may encounter technical recommendations, competing priorities, and incomplete information. They need more than a list of options. They need informed guidance about what matters, what should happen next, and where risk may be developing.

Reasons to believe

- Gordon's professional profile identifies more than three decades of architectural and project leadership experience.

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- His experience includes public-sector, institutional, existing-building, healthcare, commercial, industrial, utility, modular, and northern assignments.
- His stated responsibilities include client strategy, technical review, quality assurance, consultant coordination, and project delivery.
- Gordon's professional history includes principal and leadership roles dating back to 1992.
- CYNC's submissions consistently place senior judgment within active project responsibilities rather than limiting it to executive oversight.

3. Understanding the problem before prescribing the solution

CYNC begins by defining what must be solved before committing the client to a particular answer.

This is one of the clearest and most meaningful expressions of CYNC's approach.

Not every project should begin with a predetermined design solution. Existing conditions, operating requirements, performance criteria, technical risks, regulatory considerations, and available resources may first need to be understood.

CYNC creates value by organizing that investigation and helping the client establish an informed direction.

Why it matters

Beginning with an assumed answer can result in unsuitable scope, unnecessary cost, redesign, or a solution that does not address the underlying issue.

A structured assessment and options process helps the client understand the consequences of different directions before making a significant commitment.

Reasons to believe

- In the City of Calgary Fire Training Academy Water Reuse submission, CYNC states that the project should not begin with a predetermined solution.
- The proposed first phase is structured to understand the existing system, define the water-quality problem, establish performance criteria, evaluate treatment options, and recommend a preferred path forward.
- The submission explicitly distinguishes the assessment and options stage from later detailed design.
- The proposed approach is intended to protect the client's budget, avoid premature commitment to an unsuitable solution, and establish a clear path to construction and long-term operation.

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- The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission similarly begins with information review, coordinated site assessment, confirmation of existing conditions, and prioritized recommendations before detailed design proceeds.

The Fire Training Academy submission is evidence of CYNC's proposed methodology and project understanding. It should not be represented as a completed CYNC project unless the assignment is awarded and delivered.

4. Single-point accountability

CYNC gives the client one clearly responsible project lead.

Multidisciplinary work can become fragmented when each consultant is focused only on an individual scope. CYNC's Prime Consultant model provides one point through which the overall project is led, coordinated, and communicated.

This does not remove the responsibilities of specialist consultants. It ensures that their contributions are connected and that the client knows who is responsible for maintaining the integrated response.

Why it matters

Clients should not need to manage gaps between architectural, engineering, cost, regulatory, and specialty disciplines. Clear accountability reduces ambiguity, improves communication, and helps decisions move through the team efficiently.

Reasons to believe

- The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission explicitly identifies a "single point of accountability through CYNC as Prime Consultant and Project Lead."
- CYNC's listed responsibilities include overall contract leadership, client interface, consultant coordination, schedule, budget, quality management, tendering, and construction administration.
- The City of Calgary Fire Training Academy scope identifies CYNC as the proposed Prime Consultant responsible for coordinating the City, CYNC's subconsultants, and other consultants engaged by the City.
- CYNC's current Calgary Board of Education modular classroom work identifies the firm as Prime Consultant and Architectural Lead across six school sites.

5. The ability to assemble and coordinate specialists

CYNC builds the consultant team around the actual requirements and risks of the project.

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A complex assignment may require expertise beyond architecture. CYNC's role is to identify those requirements, assemble appropriately qualified specialists, establish responsibilities, and integrate their work into a coherent project response.

The firm's value is not based on claiming to possess every specialization internally. It is based on knowing what expertise is required and leading it effectively.

Why it matters

Specialist expertise creates value only when it is properly scoped, coordinated, and connected to the client's objectives. Without integration, specialist recommendations can conflict with each other, overlook project constraints, or create gaps in delivery.

Reasons to believe

- CYNC's corporate profile states that the firm regularly leads teams involving mechanical, electrical, structural, civil, cost, and specialty consultants.
- For the Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission, CYNC assembled mechanical and electrical engineers, a wildlife and bat specialist, and a professional cost consultant around the assignment's specific risks.
- The proposed project structure included integrated review of mechanical systems, building envelope, wildlife exclusion, controls, construction phasing, and cost.
- For the Fire Training Academy Water Reuse submission, CYNC developed a proposed team involving water treatment, civil, mechanical, electrical, environmental, controls, hydraulic, and cost expertise.
- CYNC's ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom program involves the coordination of architectural, mechanical, electrical, structural, civil, code, accessibility, security, and site requirements across six locations.

6. Comfort with operational and regulatory complexity

CYNC understands that projects must function within operating organizations, approval systems, and existing conditions.

Architectural decisions are often constrained by how a facility operates, who uses it, which authorities govern it, and how work can be implemented.

CYNC's approach accounts for operational continuity, public access, safety, permitting, regulatory requirements, seasonal limitations, and coordination with authorities.

Why it matters

A design can be technically or visually successful and still create significant difficulties if it overlooks operations, approvals, construction sequencing, or the realities of the existing facility.

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Clients need an architectural partner who can consider these conditions early and incorporate them into the project strategy.

Reasons to believe

- The completed Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades project involved public-facing facilities, seasonal operations, aging buildings, accessibility, public safety, construction-phase issue resolution, and coordination with Alberta Parks and the contractor.
- CYNC's ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom work involves occupied school sites, fast-track delivery, permitting support, code and land-use review, accessibility, fire access, existing-building connections, and coordination with Alberta Infrastructure and the Authority Having Jurisdiction.
- The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission addresses operating public facilities in a non-urban environment, together with seasonal limitations, wildlife intrusion, mechanical and controls requirements, public disruption, and procurement constraints.
- The Fire Training Academy Water Reuse submission includes operational requirements, health and safety considerations, permitting, regulatory review, maintenance implications, and long-term performance criteria.
- Gordon's professional profile identifies experience in active operational environments and emphasizes code-aware review and consultant coordination.

7. Practical, durable, and maintainable solutions

CYNC evaluates design quality in relation to long-term performance and use.

CYNC's approach does not separate design from implementation, operation, or maintenance. The firm considers whether a solution is appropriate for the client's budget, facility, users, operating conditions, and long-term responsibilities.

Practicality does not diminish architectural quality. It ensures that design intent is supported by constructability, durability, maintainability, and operational value.

Why it matters

Clients remain responsible for their facilities long after design and construction are complete. Material choices, system decisions, access requirements, maintenance needs, and operating costs can have a lasting effect on the value of the project.

Reasons to believe

- CYNC's corporate profile emphasizes practical delivery, clear documentation, and responsive construction-phase support.
- The completed Lake Sikome work included coordinated upgrades intended to support public access, operations, safety, maintainability, and seasonal use.

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- The project involved the renovation of five existing buildings, two admissions booths, a water safety centre, and related site improvements within an active provincial park environment.
- CYNC's Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission defines the intended result as durable, maintainable, and operationally appropriate.
- The Fire Training Academy submission evaluates options in relation to capital cost, operating cost, constructability, operational impact, maintenance, implementation risk, and compatibility with the existing system.
- Gordon's professional profile emphasizes practical planning, durable detailing, technical review, and construction-phase delivery.

8. Experience across public, institutional, and industrial environments

CYNC applies a consistent leadership approach across different project and organizational contexts.

CYNC is not defined by one building type. The connecting element across its experience is the need to coordinate people, technical requirements, operational conditions, approvals, and delivery responsibilities.

This allows CYNC to bring relevant lessons from one environment into another while remaining responsive to the specific requirements of each client and sector.

Why it matters

Organizations may want evidence of direct sector familiarity, but they also benefit from a partner who understands wider project patterns such as existing-building constraints, multidisciplinary coordination, public accountability, technical integration, and construction within active facilities.

Reasons to believe

- CYNC's corporate profile identifies prime consulting, architectural design, coordination, tendering, and construction administration experience across public-sector, institutional, educational, and park-related work in Alberta.
- CYNC's current project references include the completed Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades and the ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom program across six school sites.
- Gordon's professional profile identifies more than 30 years of leadership across public-sector, institutional, healthcare, industrial, commercial, utility, modular, existing-building, and northern projects.

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- His recent experience includes modular classrooms, technically coordinated industrial facilities, utility infrastructure, healthcare upgrades, northern maintenance buildings, and food-production and recycling assignments.
- CYNC's submissions demonstrate an ability to structure project teams and delivery approaches around different technical, organizational, and operating conditions.

Where experience belongs to Gordon's professional history rather than a project completed by CYNC Architecture Inc., the website should make that distinction clear.

The combined difference

CYNC's most defensible differentiation does not rest on being the largest firm, producing the greatest volume of work, or promoting one recognizable architectural style.

Its difference is the combination of:

- Direct access to experienced leadership
- Careful definition of the project problem
- Clear and candid professional advice
- One accountable Prime Consultant
- Specialist teams assembled around project needs
- Disciplined coordination across technical and organizational complexity
- Attention to practical delivery and long-term performance
- Experience in environments where the consequences of project decisions matter

Together, these differentiators support the perception CYNC wants to establish:

> **CYNC understands the situation, knows what questions to ask, brings the right people together, and can be trusted to lead the project forward.**

Evidence required for the website

The revised website should not present these differentiators as unsupported marketing statements. Each should be reinforced through visible evidence, including:

- Gordon's credentials and professional history
- Clear descriptions of CYNC's role on each project
- Accurate distinction between completed, current, and proposed work
- Project stories organized around challenges, decisions, and outcomes
- Examples of multidisciplinary consultant leadership
- Specific operational, regulatory, or delivery conditions addressed
- Client testimonials, where available and approved
- Relevant project facts, such as sector, scope, status, budget, and responsibilities

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- A clear explanation of CYNC's project process

Before publication, project details, client names, images, budgets, status, and measurable outcomes should be confirmed by CYNC and approved for public use.

10. Brand Pillars

Organizing the outward-facing brand narrative

The brand pillars translate CYNC's positioning into four themes that prospective clients can understand and remember.

The values describe how CYNC behaves. The differentiators establish why CYNC is a credible choice. The brand pillars organize those ideas into a clear external narrative that can be used throughout the website, proposals, presentations, and business development materials.

The pillars are not intended to function as four separate slogans. They should work together to tell one connected story:

1. CYNC understands the situation before recommending a response.
2. CYNC applies experienced judgment to the decisions that follow.
3. CYNC leads and coordinates the people responsible for delivery.
4. CYNC remains focused on an outcome that will work over the long term.

Pillar 1: Clarity Before Design

What CYNC believes

CYNC believes the quality of a solution depends on the quality of the understanding that precedes it.

A project should not begin with a predetermined answer when the existing conditions, operational requirements, performance criteria, risks, or client priorities have not been sufficiently established.

Design remains central to CYNC's work, but design should respond to a clearly understood problem.

What CYNC does

CYNC begins by examining the wider project situation. Depending on the engagement, this may include:

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- Reviewing existing information and documentation
- Investigating existing conditions
- Listening to owners, users, operators, and other stakeholders
- Identifying operational and technical constraints
- Confirming objectives and performance requirements
- Recognizing gaps in available information
- Identifying regulatory and approval considerations
- Evaluating available options
- Establishing decision criteria
- Recommending a clear path forward

This approach allows design to begin from an informed position rather than an assumption.

The client benefit

Clients gain a clearer understanding of:

- What problem must be solved
- Which information is still required
- What options are available
- What consequences or risks accompany each option
- Which direction is most appropriate
- What should happen next

This supports better decisions and reduces the risk of investing prematurely in a solution that may not address the underlying problem.

Supporting evidence

- The City of Calgary Fire Training Academy Water Reuse submission states that the project should not begin with a predetermined treatment solution.
- CYNC proposed an initial phase focused on understanding the existing system, defining the water-quality problem, establishing performance criteria, reviewing regulatory considerations, evaluating options, and recommending a preferred direction.
- The proposed approach separated assessment and options analysis from detailed design and construction documentation.
- The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission similarly begins with information review, existing-condition assessment, identification of operational findings, and prioritized recommendations.
- CYNC's ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom work includes review and verification of preliminary studies, existing-building connections, site conditions, code requirements, accessibility, and required infrastructure before coordinated documentation is completed.

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The Fire Training Academy and Peter Lougheed submissions demonstrate CYNC's proposed methodology. They should not be presented as completed project experience unless those assignments are awarded and delivered.

How it should appear on the website

This pillar should influence both messaging and content structure.

The website should:

- Introduce CYNC as a firm that helps clients understand complex project situations
- Explain that CYNC begins by listening, investigating, and defining
- Present assessment, feasibility, and options analysis as meaningful professional services
- Use project stories that identify the original situation before showing the design response
- Explain important project decisions and the reasoning behind them
- Include process language such as "understand," "assess," "define," "evaluate," and "recommend"
- Avoid opening with generic claims about creativity or visual excellence
- Avoid allowing finished photography to imply that the building's appearance is the entire story

A visitor should understand within the first few seconds that CYNC does not rush to impose a solution. The firm begins by making sense of the situation.

Pillar 2: Judgment Grounded in Experience

What CYNC believes

CYNC believes experience matters when it improves the quality of the advice a client receives.

Years of practice alone are not the differentiator. The value lies in recognizing patterns, anticipating consequences, asking better questions, and applying lessons from previous work to the circumstances of the current project.

Experienced judgment allows CYNC to distinguish between what is important, what requires further investigation, and what may be unnecessary.

What CYNC does

CYNC applies senior judgment throughout the project rather than limiting it to initial discussions or final review.

This includes:

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- Providing direct principal involvement
- Evaluating information in relation to the wider project context
- Identifying risks and dependencies
- Advising the client on available options
- Recognizing when specialist expertise is required
- Balancing design, technical, operational, financial, and scheduling considerations
- Reviewing work at critical decision points
- Communicating a clear professional recommendation
- Maintaining continuity between early decisions and later delivery

The client benefit

Clients receive guidance from someone who understands how decisions made at one stage may affect approvals, documentation, cost, construction, operations, and long-term performance.

This helps clients:

- Focus on the issues that materially affect the outcome
- Make decisions with greater confidence
- Recognize risks earlier
- Avoid unnecessary complexity
- Understand the implications of different directions
- Benefit from senior experience throughout the engagement

Supporting evidence

- Gordon Murray is the Founder and Principal of CYNC Architecture and holds the professional designations AAA, AIBC, SAA, and FRAIC.
- His professional profile identifies more than three decades of architectural and project leadership experience.
- His responsibilities have included client strategy, consultant coordination, technical review, quality assurance, and project delivery.
- His experience includes public-sector, institutional, existing-building, healthcare, commercial, industrial, utility, modular, and northern assignments.
- CYNC's proposals identify Gordon as the Principal-in-Charge, Project Lead, senior client contact, Prime Consultant lead, and senior reviewer.
- The completed Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades and the ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom program provide current evidence of CYNC applying architectural leadership in public and institutional environments.

How it should appear on the website

This pillar should be demonstrated through substance rather than repeated claims about years of experience.

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The website should:

- Give Gordon's leadership role appropriate visibility
- Present his credentials and professional history clearly
- Explain how direct principal involvement affects the client experience
- Include project stories that describe important decisions, risks, and recommendations
- Demonstrate how experience influenced the project approach
- Use concise professional commentary to explain CYNC's thinking
- Connect team biographies to responsibilities and areas of judgment
- Avoid relying only on awards, titles, or a chronological résumé
- Avoid broad claims such as "industry-leading" unless supported by objective evidence

Visitors should conclude that CYNC's experience is active, relevant, and directly available to them.

Pillar 3: Accountable Leadership and Coordination

What CYNC believes

CYNC believes complex projects require a clear point of leadership.

Specialists may each perform their own scope, but the client needs someone responsible for understanding how those contributions connect and whether the complete project response remains aligned with the original objective.

Collaboration is most effective when roles are clear, communication is organized, and accountability is maintained.

What CYNC does

As Prime Consultant and Project Lead, CYNC:

- Serves as the primary client contact
- Establishes project objectives, responsibilities, and communication protocols
- Identifies and assembles the required consultant disciplines
- Coordinates architectural, engineering, cost, regulatory, and specialty inputs
- Connects specialist recommendations to the larger project context
- Tracks decisions, actions, and unresolved questions
- Monitors alignment among scope, schedule, budget, and quality
- Coordinates tender and construction documentation
- Supports the client during procurement and construction
- Maintains continuity through close-out

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CYNC does not claim to perform every specialist discipline. It takes responsibility for bringing the necessary expertise together and leading it as one coordinated team.

The client benefit

The client receives:

- One clearly responsible project lead
- More consistent communication
- Clearer roles and expectations
- Better integration between disciplines
- Fewer unresolved gaps between consultant responsibilities
- Greater continuity across project phases
- More coordinated documents and recommendations
- A team structured around the project's actual requirements

This reduces the management burden placed on the client and helps maintain alignment as the project becomes more detailed.

Supporting evidence

- The Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission explicitly identifies a single point of accountability through CYNC as Prime Consultant and Project Lead.
- Gordon is identified as the primary contact responsible for project communication, consultant coordination, schedule management, architectural and envelope coordination, tender documentation, and construction administration.
- CYNC assembled a proposed project team involving mechanical and electrical engineers, wildlife and bat expertise, and professional cost consulting.
- The proposed review process integrated mechanical systems, building envelope, wildlife exclusion, controls, construction phasing, and cost.
- The City of Calgary Fire Training Academy submission identifies CYNC as the proposed Prime Consultant responsible for coordinating the City, subconsultants, and other project participants.
- CYNC's ongoing Calgary Board of Education modular classroom program involves Prime Consultant leadership across six school sites and coordination among architectural, structural, civil, mechanical, electrical, code, accessibility, site, and authority requirements.

How it should appear on the website

This pillar should make CYNC's project leadership role visible and understandable.

The website should:

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- Clearly explain what CYNC does as Prime Consultant
- Describe the benefit of having one point of accountability
- Show how CYNC assembles teams around project requirements
- Present the project process from initial understanding through close-out
- Identify CYNC's role and responsibilities within each case study
- Credit specialist partners where appropriate
- Use simple diagrams or structured content to explain coordination
- Show that direct principal leadership continues throughout delivery
- Avoid presenting collaboration as a vague statement about teamwork
- Avoid implying that CYNC personally performs specialist services delivered by subconsultants

Visitors should understand that CYNC can lead the whole assignment while coordinating the expertise required to deliver it.

Pillar 4: Practical Outcomes Built for the Long Term

What CYNC believes

CYNC believes a successful project must work beyond the moment it is completed.

Design quality should be evaluated in relation to how the facility will be constructed, operated, maintained, adapted, and experienced over time.

A practical solution is not a lesser design solution. It is one that responds thoughtfully to the client's real conditions and continues to provide value after construction.

What CYNC does

CYNC considers:

- Constructability and implementation
- Capital and operating costs
- Operational continuity
- Durability and material performance
- Maintenance access and requirements
- Public and occupant safety
- Accessibility
- Lifecycle considerations
- Compatibility with existing buildings and systems
- Construction phasing
- Commissioning and performance verification
- Long-term usefulness to the owner and facility users

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The firm balances architectural intent with the practical responsibilities the client will continue to carry.

The client benefit

Clients receive a solution intended to:

- Function within the realities of the organization
- Make responsible use of available resources
- Reduce avoidable operational disruption
- Support safe and effective use
- Remain durable and maintainable
- Consider both immediate needs and lifecycle implications
- Translate design decisions into buildable and operable outcomes

The client can evaluate success not only by how the project looks, but also by how well it performs and supports the organization over time.

Supporting evidence

- The completed Lake Sikome Facility Upgrades project involved the comprehensive renovation of five existing buildings, two admissions booths, a water safety centre, and related site improvements.
- The project addressed public access, operations, safety, maintainability, seasonal use, accessibility, existing conditions, and construction-phase issue resolution.
- CYNC's Peter Lougheed Provincial Park submission defines the intended outcome as durable, maintainable, and operationally appropriate.
- The proposed Peter Lougheed approach includes lifecycle information, existing-condition review, cost reconciliation, construction phasing, commissioning, and close-out.
- The Fire Training Academy submission evaluates potential options in relation to capital cost, operating cost, constructability, operational impacts, maintenance implications, implementation risks, and compatibility with the existing system.
- Gordon's professional profile emphasizes practical planning, durable detailing, code-aware review, and coordination within active operational environments.

How it should appear on the website

This pillar should change how CYNC presents projects and outcomes.

The website should:

- Explain how each project supports actual users and operations

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- Include relevant facts about renovation, phasing, maintainability, accessibility, and lifecycle value
- Describe the outcome in practical as well as architectural terms
- Use completed project photography as evidence of a working solution
- Include diagrams, details, process images, or before-and-after information where useful
- Show how the project responded to existing conditions and constraints
- Present client or operator testimonials where approved
- Identify measurable outcomes when accurate information is available
- Avoid describing success only through visual language
- Avoid unsupported claims about performance or savings

Visitors should see that CYNC designs for real conditions, real responsibilities, and long-term use.

How the four pillars work together

The pillars describe a complete client experience.

Clarity Before Design establishes that CYNC begins by understanding the situation.

Judgment Grounded in Experience gives the client confidence in the advice and decisions that follow.

Accountable Leadership and Coordination explains how CYNC organizes the project and carries responsibility through delivery.

Practical Outcomes Built for the Long Term defines the standard against which the completed response should be evaluated.

Together, they support one clear market position:

> **CYNC brings clarity to complex building challenges, applies experienced judgment, leads the right team, and delivers solutions shaped for long-term use.**

Role of the pillars within the website

The four pillars should not be confined to a single section of the website. They should influence the entire digital experience.

They should shape:

- The homepage narrative
- Service descriptions
- The project process

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- About and leadership content
- Project selection and categorization
- Case study structure
- Calls to action
- Image selection
- Testimonials
- Article and insight topics
- Proposal and qualification language

Each major page should reinforce at least one pillar, while the homepage should introduce all four as parts of one coherent CYNC story.

Part III: Brand Expression

11. Brand Personality

How the CYNC brand should feel

Brand personality defines how CYNC's strategy is experienced.

It should reflect the character of the firm, the way CYNC works with clients, and the impression created when someone reads the website, reviews a proposal, meets the team, or examines a project.

The personality should not feel like an invented marketing persona. It should be a clear and consistent expression of qualities already evident in CYNC's leadership and project approach.

Personality in one statement

> **CYNC should feel like the experienced project leader at the table who understands the complexity, speaks plainly, remains personally engaged, and brings calm direction without needing to command attention.**

The primary personality characteristics are:

- Grounded
- Straightforward
- Substantive
- Quietly confident
- Experienced

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- Engaged and human

Grounded

Connected to real conditions, real responsibilities, and achievable outcomes.

CYNC should feel firmly rooted in the realities of the project. The brand should demonstrate an understanding of budgets, existing conditions, technical requirements, operations, approvals, construction, and long-term use.

Grounded does not mean conservative or visually ordinary. It means that ideas are connected to purpose and that creativity is presented as a thoughtful response to the client's situation.

In expression, this means:

- Using credible and specific language
- Connecting design decisions to project requirements
- Showing actual work, people, processes, and environments
- Discussing constraints without treating them as limitations on creativity
- Avoiding inflated promises and abstract brand language
- Selecting imagery that feels authentic rather than staged
- Presenting CYNC as calm and dependable

A grounded brand gives the impression that CYNC understands how projects work beyond the presentation stage.

Straightforward

Clear about what CYNC does, how it works, and what clients can expect.

CYNC should communicate directly and make complex subjects easier to understand. Visitors should not need to interpret vague language to determine the firm's role or relevance.

Straightforward communication does not mean oversimplifying technical matters. It means organizing information clearly, using precise language, and explaining technical issues in relation to the client's decisions.

In expression, this means:

- Leading with the most important point
- Using plain language where possible
- Explaining specialist terminology when it is necessary
- Writing concise headings with clear meaning
- Making services and responsibilities easy to understand

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- Giving direct answers to likely client questions
- Avoiding unnecessary jargon and decorative language
- Avoiding claims that could apply to almost any architecture firm

A straightforward brand respects the client's time and intelligence.

Substantive

Supported by real thinking, relevant detail, and credible evidence.

CYNC should provide enough information to demonstrate depth. The brand should explain the problems the firm helps solve, the responsibilities it assumes, the decisions it supports, and the outcomes it helps create.

Substance does not require excessive text. A concise statement can be substantive when it communicates something specific, relevant, and supported by evidence.

In expression, this means:

- Supporting claims with project examples
- Explaining CYNC's role rather than listing only project names
- Showing the reasoning behind important decisions
- Including relevant project conditions, constraints, and outcomes
- Presenting credentials and experience accurately
- Using diagrams, facts, and process information where they improve understanding
- Distinguishing completed work from current assignments and proposed approaches
- Removing language that sounds impressive but communicates little

A substantive brand leaves the visitor with a clearer understanding of why CYNC is qualified to help.

Quietly Confident

Assured without exaggeration.

CYNC should communicate confidence through clarity, experience, and evidence rather than volume or self-promotion.

The firm does not need to present itself as the biggest, most innovative, or most visionary practice. Its confidence should come from knowing its role, understanding the work, and being prepared to take responsibility.

In expression, this means:

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- Using clear and declarative statements
- Allowing evidence to support the claim
- Presenting experience without overstating it
- Maintaining a calm and controlled visual presence
- Using restrained typography, movement, and interaction
- Avoiding excessive superlatives
- Avoiding dramatic claims about transforming architecture or redefining industries
- Giving projects, responsibilities, and outcomes room to speak for themselves

Quiet confidence should make CYNC feel secure in its capabilities and comfortable with the seriousness of its work.

Experienced

Informed by decades of practice, but focused on current and future challenges.

Experience is central to CYNC's credibility. It should be visible in the quality of the firm's judgment, the questions it asks, the teams it assembles, and the way it anticipates project consequences.

The brand should not present experience only as longevity. It should demonstrate how that experience benefits the client today.

In expression, this means:

- Making direct principal involvement visible
- Connecting Gordon's professional history to present client needs
- Demonstrating how experience influences decisions
- Showing current capabilities and active project responsibilities
- Presenting credentials clearly and accurately
- Communicating familiarity with different project environments
- Balancing established expertise with contemporary design and delivery practices
- Avoiding language or visual choices that make the firm appear fixed in the past

CYNC should feel seasoned, current, and capable of adapting its experience to the specific circumstances of each assignment.

Engaged and Human

Personally involved, attentive, and accessible.

Clients should feel that CYNC will listen to them, understand their concerns, and remain involved as the project develops.

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The firm's professionalism should not create distance. Its smaller leadership structure and direct principal involvement provide an opportunity to communicate a more personal and responsive client experience.

In expression, this means:

- Writing in a clear and natural voice
- Showing the people responsible for the work
- Explaining what clients can expect when working with CYNC
- Making leadership feel visible and accessible
- Presenting collaboration as active participation
- Recognizing the client's pressures and responsibilities
- Using photography that shows people working, discussing, reviewing, and building
- Creating calls to action that invite a real conversation
- Avoiding a tone that feels impersonal, overly polished, or institutional

Human does not mean casual. CYNC should remain professional while making it clear that clients will work with attentive and accountable people.

Personality boundaries

The brand personality must maintain careful balance. Each positive characteristic can become counterproductive if it is expressed too aggressively or without restraint.

CYNC should feel	CYNC should not feel
Confident	Self-important
Experienced	Old-fashioned
Direct	Abrupt
Professional	Corporate and distant

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Creative	Theatrical
Substantive	Dense or academic
Approachable	Casual or lightweight
Grounded	Conventional or uninspired
Technical	Difficult to understand
Calm	Passive or disengaged

Applying the boundaries

Confident, not self-important

CYNC should state its capabilities clearly and support them with evidence. It should avoid language that elevates the firm above the client, consultant partners, or project.

Experienced, not old-fashioned

Professional history should demonstrate judgment and credibility while the website's design, content, and digital experience remain contemporary.

Direct, not abrupt

Communication should reach the point quickly while still providing context, respect, and an understanding of the client's situation.

Professional, not corporate and distant

The brand should feel disciplined and credible without relying on impersonal corporate language, stock expressions, or overly formal presentation.

Creative, not theatrical

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Architectural creativity should be visible through intelligent responses to real project conditions. It should not depend on dramatic language, excessive visual effects, or design gestures that distract from the substance.

Substantive, not dense or academic

The website should provide meaningful information in a structured and accessible form. Technical detail should be included when it helps the client understand the project, decision, or outcome.

Approachable, not casual or lightweight

CYNC should invite conversation and communicate naturally while maintaining the seriousness appropriate to public, institutional, industrial, and development work.

Grounded, not conventional or uninspired

A practical position should not remove ambition or design quality. The brand can be visually distinctive while remaining purposeful and restrained.

Technical, not difficult to understand

Technical capability should increase client confidence. It should not create a barrier through unexplained terminology or unnecessary complexity.

Calm, not passive or disengaged

Quiet confidence should still communicate energy, responsiveness, and active leadership.

Personality across the client experience

The personality should remain consistent across every point of contact:

- The website should feel clear, considered, restrained, and relevant.
- Proposals should feel structured, informed, and specific to the assignment.
- Project stories should focus on context, decisions, coordination, and outcomes.
- Team profiles should communicate credibility and personal involvement.
- Calls to action should feel direct and conversational.
- Photography should balance completed architecture with people, process, details, and real operating environments.
- Client communication should remain candid, responsive, and respectful.

Personality test

Before approving a piece of website content or brand expression, CYNC and Novus should ask:

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1. Does this feel grounded in something real?
2. Does it communicate the point clearly?
3. Is there enough substance to support the claim?
4. Does it demonstrate confidence without exaggeration?
5. Does it make CYNC's experience relevant to the client?
6. Does it feel like it comes from engaged and accountable people?

If the answer to these questions is yes, the expression is likely consistent with the intended CYNC personality.

12. Tone of Voice

How CYNC should sound

Tone of voice translates CYNC's personality and positioning into language.

CYNC should sound like an experienced principal explaining a complex project to an intelligent client: clear, candid, calm, specific, and useful.

The voice should demonstrate expertise without becoming academic, communicate confidence without exaggeration, and remain professional without feeling distant.

Voice in one statement

> **CYNC communicates complex ideas clearly, provides a direct professional perspective, and supports its claims with relevant evidence.**

Writing principles

1. Clear before clever

The reader should understand the meaning before noticing the writing.

Headlines and body copy should communicate a useful idea rather than depend on wordplay, abstract concepts, or architectural language that requires interpretation.

Apply this principle by:

- Leading with the main point
- Using familiar words where they are accurate
- Explaining technical terminology when required
- Giving headings a clear informational purpose

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- Removing language that sounds impressive but obscures the meaning

Instead of:

> Architecture shaped by intention.

Consider:

> Clear direction for complex building projects.

2. Specific rather than grandiose

Specific language builds credibility. Grand statements create expectations that are difficult to support and frequently sound similar to the claims made by other architecture firms.

CYNC should explain what it does, how it contributes, and why that contribution matters.

Apply this principle by:

- Naming the client situation
- Identifying CYNC's actual role
- Describing the action taken
- Explaining the decision or outcome
- Replacing broad adjectives with relevant facts

Instead of:

> We create transformative environments that redefine possibility.

Consider:

> We help clients assess existing conditions, evaluate their options, and establish a practical path through design and delivery.

3. Confident without exaggeration

Confidence should come from the clarity of the statement and the quality of the evidence.

CYNC does not need to describe itself as visionary, leading, revolutionary, or unmatched. Its experience, responsibilities, credentials, and project outcomes should establish credibility.

Apply this principle by:

- Using direct, declarative sentences
- Stating capabilities without qualification when they are verified

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- Supporting claims with relevant experience
- Distinguishing company experience from individual experience
- Avoiding guarantees and absolute claims
- Identifying proposed work as proposed and current work as current

Instead of:

> CYNC delivers unparalleled expertise on every project.

Consider:

> Clients work directly with Gordon Murray, CYNC's Founder and Principal, throughout the project.

4. Professional but conversational

CYNC should sound knowledgeable and composed, but it should not sound like an institution speaking through a policy document.

The website should feel as though a capable and experienced person is communicating directly with the reader.

Apply this principle by:

- Using natural sentence structures
- Using "we" when speaking about CYNC's approach
- Using "you" selectively when addressing a client question or benefit
- Keeping explanations respectful and accessible
- Avoiding unnecessary formality
- Avoiding language that is overly casual or promotional

Instead of:

> CYNC Architecture Inc. endeavours to facilitate the realization of client objectives through the provision of multidisciplinary professional services.

Consider:

> We bring the right disciplines together and keep the work aligned with your project objectives.

5. Focused on client realities

The voice should begin with the situation the client is facing, not with CYNC's desire to describe itself.

Prospective clients may be dealing with aging facilities, operational disruption, approvals, budget constraints, technical dependencies, public accountability, or an uncertain path forward. The language should demonstrate that CYNC understands these conditions.

Apply this principle by:

- Starting with a recognizable client situation
- Connecting services to decisions the client must make
- Explaining how CYNC reduces uncertainty or improves coordination
- Recognizing operational and organizational pressures
- Describing benefits from the client's perspective

Instead of:

> Our multidisciplinary expertise enables comprehensive project delivery.

Consider:

> When a project involves several technical disciplines, CYNC provides one point of accountability and coordinates their work around the client's objectives.

6. Evidence-led

Important claims should be supported by credentials, responsibilities, project examples, or documented outcomes.

Evidence does not need to interrupt the narrative. It can appear through project details, role descriptions, case studies, team profiles, statistics, and clearly identified examples.

Apply this principle by:

- Naming CYNC's role on the project
- Identifying whether a project is completed, current, or proposed
- Including relevant project conditions and responsibilities
- Using verified numbers where they add meaning
- Connecting credentials to client value
- Avoiding unsupported claims about results

Instead of:

> We have extensive experience leading complex public projects.

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Consider:

> CYNC is currently serving as Prime Consultant and Architectural Lead for six Calgary Board of Education modular classroom projects across occupied school sites.

7. Direct and economical

CYNC's writing should contain enough detail to demonstrate substance, but no more than the reader needs at that point in the experience.

The website should use progressive levels of information. Headlines establish the point, summaries explain its relevance, and project or service pages provide supporting detail.

Apply this principle by:

- Keeping one central idea in each paragraph
- Removing repeated claims
- Using bullets for comparable information
- Placing the conclusion before the supporting detail
- Linking to deeper information rather than explaining everything at once
- Editing for clarity without removing necessary substance

Words and phrases to use

The following language supports CYNC's positioning. It should be used naturally and only when accurate.

Understanding and direction

- Understand
- Assess
- Investigate
- Define
- Clarify
- Confirm
- Evaluate
- Recommend
- Prioritize
- Establish a path forward
- Make an informed decision

Leadership and coordination

- Lead

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- Advise
- Coordinate
- Integrate
- Align
- Guide
- Take responsibility
- Prime Consultant
- Project Lead
- Direct principal involvement
- Single point of accountability
- Multidisciplinary team

Project realities

- Existing conditions
- Operational requirements
- Project constraints
- Performance criteria
- Approvals
- Procurement
- Constructability
- Budget
- Schedule
- Risk
- Lifecycle
- Maintenance
- Long-term use

Outcomes and qualities

- Clear
- Practical
- Coordinated
- Informed
- Accountable
- Appropriate
- Durable
- Maintainable
- Buildable
- Operationally responsive
- Long-term value

Words and phrases to avoid

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These terms should be avoided when they are generic, exaggerated, unsupported, or inconsistent with CYNC's intended personality.

Grandiose or unsupported language

- World-class
- Industry-leading
- Unparalleled
- Best-in-class
- Revolutionary
- Groundbreaking
- Iconic
- Visionary
- Cutting-edge
- Transformative
- Game-changing
- Limitless possibilities

Generic architectural language

- Shape your vision into reality
- Bring your dreams to life
- Spaces that inspire
- Design without boundaries
- Elevated living
- Timeless elegance
- Where form meets function
- Architecture reimagined
- Building the future
- Creating extraordinary experiences

Corporate language

- Leverage
- Synergize
- Solutions-driven
- Value-added
- End-to-end solutions
- Stakeholder ecosystem
- Seamless execution
- Strategic alignment, when a simpler phrase will work
- Optimize outcomes, without explaining which outcomes

Absolute or risky claims

- Always on time
- Always on budget
- Risk-free
- We eliminate uncertainty
- Guaranteed results
- Flawless delivery
- We handle everything
- No compromises

Terms such as “innovative,” “unique,” “sustainable,” and “holistic” should be used only when the content explains what makes the approach innovative, unique, sustainable, or holistic.

Before-and-after messaging examples

The examples below illustrate the intended shift in voice. They are strategic examples rather than final website copy.

Application	Less effective expression	Recommended direction
Homepage headline	The Architecture of Intent	Clear direction for complex building projects.
Homepage introduction	We create thoughtful spaces that shape how people live and work.	CYNC helps organizations understand complex building and facility challenges, coordinate the right expertise, and move confidently from early decisions through delivery.
Company description	CYNC is an Alberta-based studio focused on disciplined creativity, structural honesty, and intentional design.	CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice providing experienced leadership, clear advice, and coordinated project delivery.

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Service introduction	We provide innovative, end-to-end architectural solutions.	We help clients define project requirements, assess existing conditions, coordinate specialist consultants, and carry decisions through design and construction.
Prime Consultant message	We collaborate with a diverse team of industry experts.	As Prime Consultant, CYNC provides one point of accountability and coordinates the specialists required for the project.
Experience claim	Our extensive experience allows us to deliver exceptional results.	Gordon Murray brings more than 30 years of architectural and project leadership experience directly to CYNC's client engagements.
Project introduction	A transformative renovation that reimagines the visitor experience.	Five existing public-use buildings required coordinated renewal within an active, seasonally operated provincial park.
Project role	CYNC worked with the client to bring the project to life.	CYNC provided architectural and project support for the renewal, coordinating upgrades related to public access, operations, safety, and maintainability.
Outcome statement	The result is a timeless and inspiring destination.	The completed upgrades support public use, seasonal operations, safety, accessibility, and the long-term maintenance of the facility.
General call to action	Shape your vision into reality.	Discuss your project with CYNC.

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Situation-based call to action	Start your journey today.	Need clarity on what comes next? Start a conversation.

Guidance for headlines

Headlines should communicate one clear idea and help visitors understand the page quickly.

Effective CYNC headlines should:

- Lead with a client need, project reality, or meaningful outcome
- Be understandable without supporting context
- Use active and direct language
- Remain concise
- Avoid architectural clichés
- Avoid relying on cleverness to create interest
- Create a clear hierarchy from one section to the next

Recommended headline examples

- Clear direction for complex projects
- Understand the problem before designing the response
- One accountable lead from definition through delivery
- Experience applied where decisions matter
- Coordinating the right expertise
- Designed for real operating conditions
- Practical decisions with long-term value
- Public projects require more than a design
- Existing buildings come with existing realities

Guidance for body copy

Body copy should explain the headline, support it with relevant detail, and connect the subject to the client's needs.

Effective body copy should:

- Present the main conclusion in the opening sentence
- Use short, focused paragraphs
- Explain what CYNC does and why it matters
- Connect technical responsibilities to client benefits
- Use specific examples where possible

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- Introduce detail gradually
- Use bullets when readers need to compare several points
- Avoid repeating the same positioning statement on every page
- Avoid describing CYNC CYNC entirely through adjectives

The website should use “we” when communicating CYNC’s perspective and approach. Third-person references to “CYNC” are appropriate in formal company profiles, project data, and proposal-oriented content.

Guidance for project stories

Project stories should demonstrate how CYNC thinks and works. They should not function only as image galleries.

Each project story should answer:

1. What situation was the client facing?
2. What made the assignment complicated?
3. What was CYNC’s role?
4. What did CYNC need to understand or resolve?
5. Which disciplines and stakeholders were involved?
6. What decisions or recommendations shaped the response?
7. What was delivered?
8. What practical or operational outcome resulted?

Project stories should:

- Distinguish completed, current, and proposed work
- Identify CYNC’s precise role
- Give appropriate credit to consultants and partners
- Use verified facts and measurements
- Explain the relationship between the problem and the design
- Include project imagery as evidence
- Avoid assigning results to CYNC that depended on the wider team
- Avoid claims that cannot be confirmed

Guidance for calls to action

Calls to action should be direct, useful, and appropriate to the visitor’s position in the decision process.

Primary calls to action

- Discuss your project

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- Start a conversation
- Contact CYNC
- Speak with Gordon
- Tell us what you are working through

Content-related calls to action

- View the project
- Read the project story
- See CYNC's role
- Explore our approach
- Review our services
- Meet the team

Calls to action to avoid

- Unlock your potential
- Transform your vision
- Begin your journey
- Discover the possibilities
- Dream with us
- Learn more, when a more specific action is available

A call to action should tell the visitor what will happen next. It should invite a professional conversation rather than force a sales interaction.

Final voice standard

Every piece of CYNC content should leave the reader with the impression that the firm:

- Understands the client's situation
- Knows what information matters
- Can explain complicated issues clearly
- Provides a direct professional perspective
- Supports its claims with evidence
- Respects the reader's time
- Is prepared to remain accountable for the work

The objective is not to make CYNC sound like a marketing organization. It is to make the quality of CYNC's thinking, leadership, and experience visible through the way the firm communicates.

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13. Messaging Framework

Purpose of the messaging framework

The messaging framework translates CYNC's positioning, pillars, personality, and tone of voice into reusable language.

It establishes what CYNC should communicate consistently while allowing the wording to adapt to different pages, audiences, projects, proposals, and conversations.

The framework is organized as a hierarchy:

Message level	Purpose	Content
Primary message	Establish CYNC's relevance	Clear direction for complex building projects
Supporting message	Explain how CYNC creates value	Understand, advise, coordinate, and lead
Brand pillars	Organize the wider narrative	Clarity, judgment, accountability, and long-term outcomes
Reasons to believe	Support the claims	Credentials, roles, experience, projects, and documented results
Calls to action	Invite the next step	Begin a relevant professional conversation

Primary brand message

CYNC brings clear direction to complex building and facility projects.

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This message establishes the client benefit while preserving a clear connection to CYNC's architectural and project leadership role.

It is broad enough to apply across public, institutional, industrial, development, and private-sector work without becoming generic.

Supporting message

> **We help clients understand the situation, make sound decisions, coordinate the right expertise, and carry a practical response from early assessment through design and delivery.**

The supporting message explains how CYNC creates the clarity promised in the primary message.

It introduces four connected responsibilities:

- Understanding the wider project situation
- Advising the client on an appropriate direction
- Coordinating the required disciplines
- Maintaining accountability through delivery

Recommended homepage message

Headline

> **Clear direction for complex building projects.**

Supporting copy

> **CYNC helps organizations understand complex building and facility challenges, make informed decisions, and coordinate the right expertise from early assessment through design and delivery.**

Primary call to action

> **Discuss your project**

Secondary call to action

> **Explore our approach**

Alternative homepage headline directions

A small number of headline options can be presented to CYNC for selection.

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Direction A: Client outcome

> **Clear direction for complex building projects.**

This is the recommended direction. It is direct, descriptive, and closely connected to the central positioning.

Direction B: Client situation

> **Complex projects need clear direction.**

This version begins with the client's reality and creates an immediate connection with organizations facing uncertainty or competing requirements.

Direction C: CYNC's approach

> **Understand the problem. Lead the right response.**

This version places greater emphasis on CYNC's process and leadership. It is more assertive and may work well as a supporting campaign or section headline.

Elevator description

> **CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice that helps organizations navigate complex building and facility projects. We begin by understanding existing conditions, operational needs, constraints, and risks. We then bring together the appropriate disciplines, provide clear advice, and maintain accountability through design, procurement, and construction. Clients work directly with experienced leadership and gain a coordinated, practical path forward.**

This description is suitable for:

- Verbal introductions
- Networking conversations
- Proposal introductions
- Professional profiles
- Short company presentations
- Business development meetings

Short About description

> **CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice providing experienced leadership for complex building and facility projects. We help clients**

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define project requirements, evaluate available options, coordinate specialist expertise, and carry informed decisions through design and delivery. Led by Founder and Principal Gordon Murray, CYNC combines direct senior involvement with practical judgment, clear communication, and accountable project leadership.

This version is suitable for the About page introduction, company profiles, qualification documents, and professional directories.

Full company narrative

Some architectural projects begin with a clearly defined brief. Others begin with an aging facility, an operational concern, a technical problem, or a capital decision that has not yet been fully understood. In these situations, design is not the first question. The first responsibility is to understand what is happening, what the client needs, and which factors will determine an appropriate response.

CYNC is a Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice that helps organizations navigate these complex building and facility decisions. We review existing conditions, listen to owners and operators, identify constraints and risks, coordinate specialist expertise, and provide clear recommendations about what should happen next.

As Prime Consultant and Project Lead, CYNC provides one point of accountability across the project. We bring architectural, engineering, cost, regulatory, and specialty disciplines together around the client's objectives and maintain coordination as the work progresses through design, documentation, procurement, construction, and close-out.

Clients work directly with Gordon Murray, CYNC's Founder and Principal. Gordon brings more than 30 years of architectural and project leadership experience across public-sector, institutional, existing-building, healthcare, industrial, commercial, utility, modular, and northern project environments.

Our work is grounded in a straightforward principle: understand the problem before prescribing the solution. This allows CYNC to help clients make sound decisions, use resources responsibly, manage project complexity, and move toward outcomes that are practical, durable, and appropriate for long-term use.

Headline territories

Headlines should draw from a defined set of messaging territories. This creates consistency without repeating the same words on every page.

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Territory	Purpose	Example headlines
Clarity and direction	Connect with clients facing uncertainty	Clear direction for complex projects.Start with the right questions.Define what matters before deciding what comes next.
Experienced judgment	Demonstrate the value of senior involvement	Experience applied where decisions matter.Judgment built through practice.Senior leadership from the first conversation.
Accountability and coordination	Explain CYNC's Prime Consultant role	One accountable lead.Coordinating the complete project response.The right expertise, working toward one objective.
Client realities	Show understanding of actual project conditions	Existing buildings come with existing realities.Public projects require more than a design.Design must work within operations.
Practical outcomes	Connect design with long-term value	Designed for real operating conditions.Practical decisions with long-term value.Built to function beyond completion.
Project process	Explain how CYNC works	Understand first. Design from evidence.From project definition through delivery.A clear path from uncertainty to action.

Service messaging

Services should be presented in relation to the client's need and the value CYNC provides. The website should not rely on a simple list of technical activities.

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The following service structure is supported by the project materials reviewed. Final service names and inclusions should be confirmed by CYNC before website copy is completed.

Project Definition and Advisory

Client situation

The client has a building, facility, or operational issue but may not yet have a complete brief or confirmed solution.

Service message

> **CYNC helps clients understand existing conditions, define project requirements, evaluate available options, and establish an informed path forward before significant design or construction commitments are made.**

Relevant activities may include:

- Existing-information review
- Site and facility assessment
- Project definition
- Feasibility review
- Options analysis
- Performance criteria
- Risk and constraint identification
- Preliminary recommendations
- Implementation planning

Prime Consulting and Project Leadership

Client situation

The project requires several professional disciplines and one accountable lead to coordinate them.

Service message

> **As Prime Consultant, CYNC provides one point of accountability, assembles the expertise required for the assignment, and coordinates the team around the client's objectives, budget, schedule, and operating requirements.**

Relevant activities may include:

- Consultant team assembly
- Scope and responsibility definition

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- Client and stakeholder communication
- Multidisciplinary coordination
- Schedule and deliverable management
- Budget and cost coordination
- Quality management
- Decision tracking
- Project reporting

Architectural Design and Documentation

Client situation

The client requires an architectural response that integrates design quality with technical, operational, regulatory, and construction requirements.

Service message

> **CYNC develops architectural solutions informed by the project's context, constraints, users, operations, and long-term requirements, then carries those decisions into clear and coordinated documentation.**

Relevant activities may include:

- Programming and design
- Code and regulatory review
- Design development
- Consultant integration
- Construction documentation
- Permit coordination
- Technical review
- Quality assurance

Existing Building Renewal

Client situation

An existing facility requires renovation, modernization, expansion, lifecycle renewal, or adaptation to new requirements.

Service message

> **CYNC helps owners understand existing-building conditions, identify priorities, and coordinate upgrades that respond to current needs while respecting operations, constructability, budget, and long-term maintenance.**

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Relevant activities may include:

- Existing-condition assessment
- Renovation and modernization
- Building additions
- Lifecycle renewal
- Accessibility improvements
- Envelope coordination
- Building-system integration
- Phased implementation

Tendering and Procurement Support

Client situation

The client needs coordinated documents and professional support to move from design into a formal procurement process.

Service message

> **CYNC prepares and coordinates procurement documentation, supports bidder questions and evaluations, and helps clients move into construction with clear scope and aligned information.**

Relevant activities may include:

- Tender and procurement documentation
- Bidder questions and addenda
- Bid review
- Consultant coordination
- Recommendation for award
- Issued-for-construction documentation

Construction Administration and Close-Out

Client situation

The client needs the project intent, documentation, and decisions carried responsibly through construction.

Service message

> **CYNC remains involved during construction, coordinating consultant responses, reviewing project information, documenting site observations, and supporting the client through completion and close-out.**

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Relevant activities may include:

- Construction meetings
- Site reviews
- Submittal and shop drawing reviews
- Requests for Information
- Change documentation
- Progress claim review
- Deficiency review
- Commissioning coordination
- Close-out and warranty follow-up

Any additional service categories, including interior design, should be included only after CYNC confirms their intended role and priority within the business.

Project-story messaging

Projects should demonstrate CYNC's thinking, responsibilities, and contribution. Each story should connect the visual result to the conditions and decisions that shaped it.

Recommended project-story structure

1. Situation

What was happening when the client engaged CYNC?

2. Complexity

What operational, technical, financial, regulatory, or organizational factors influenced the project?

3. CYNC's role

Was CYNC the Prime Consultant, Architectural Lead, Project Lead, or supporting architect? What responsibilities did the firm hold?

4. Approach

What did CYNC investigate, define, coordinate, recommend, or design?

5. Project team

Which disciplines and stakeholders contributed, and how did CYNC coordinate their work?

6. Outcome

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What was completed, improved, resolved, or enabled?

7. Evidence

What verified details support the story, such as project status, scope, budget, number of facilities, or operating conditions?

Sample project headline

> **Renewing five public-use buildings within an active seasonal park**

Sample project introduction

> **The Lake Sikome Aquatic Facility required comprehensive renewal across five existing buildings within an active provincial park. CYNC provided architectural and project support for improvements involving public access, seasonal operations, safety, accessibility, maintainability, and supporting site infrastructure.**

Sample role statement

> **Working as Consultant and Architectural Lead, CYNC coordinated the architectural response with Alberta Parks, the contractor, and the required technical disciplines.**

Sample outcome statement

> **The completed renewal included renovations to five existing buildings, two new admissions booths, a water safety centre, site grading, and surface restoration, supporting the facility's continued public and seasonal use.**

Calls to action

Calls to action should reflect the visitor's purpose and make the next step clear.

Primary relationship call to action

> **Discuss your project**

This should be the principal call to action across the website.

Supporting calls to action

- Start a conversation
- Contact CYNC
- Speak with Gordon
- Tell us what you are working through

Service-related calls to action

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- Explore our services
- See how CYNC works
- Discuss your requirements
- Review our approach

Project-related calls to action

- View the project
- Read the project story
- See CYNC's role
- Explore related work

Situation-based call to action

> **Need clarity on what comes next? Start a conversation with CYNC.**

Potential tagline directions

A tagline should reinforce the positioning without attempting to summarize every CYNC service.

Three directions are recommended for consideration.

Direction	Potential tagline	Strategic strength	Consideration
Client outcome	**Clarity to move forward.**	Concise, human, and applicable across sectors. Connects directly to the value clients receive.	Should be paired with a clear company description so the architectural context is immediately understood.
Project context	**Clear direction for complex projects.**	Highly descriptive and immediately relevant to CYNC's intended clients.	May function more effectively as a homepage headline than as a permanent tagline.
Leadership and delivery	**Experienced judgment.**	Communicates two of CYNC's strongest	More formal and less emotionally distinctive than the first direction.

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Accountable delivery.	differentiators in direct professional language.

Recommended tagline approach

The recommended direction is:

> **Clarity to move forward.**

It is short enough to operate as a brand line and broad enough to remain relevant across CYNC's different sectors and services.

For the homepage, it should be supported by the more descriptive headline:

> **Clear direction for complex building projects.**

This creates a useful distinction:

- The tagline expresses the enduring client benefit.
- The homepage headline explains CYNC's relevance immediately.
- The supporting copy describes how CYNC provides that value.

A no-tagline approach also remains valid. If CYNC does not believe any proposed line feels authentic, the brand can rely on a strong descriptive homepage headline and consistent messaging rather than adopting a permanent slogan prematurely.

Messaging standard

Across every application, CYNC's messaging should answer five questions:

1. What situation does the client face?
2. What does CYNC help the client understand or decide?
3. What responsibility does CYNC assume?
4. What evidence supports the claim?
5. What practical value does the client receive?

When those questions are answered clearly, the messaging will communicate more than architectural competence. It will show why clients can trust CYNC to help them move forward.

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14. Visual Direction

Purpose of the visual direction

The visual direction defines how CYNC's strategy should be expressed through design before detailed revisions are made in Figma.

It is not a replacement website design or a specification of final fonts, colours, layouts, or components. It establishes the principles the revised design should follow and identifies which elements of the current direction remain valuable.

The current Figma design provides a useful visual foundation. It demonstrates restraint, editorial composition, strong project imagery, and a considered contrast between light and dark sections. The next design phase should retain those strengths while bringing the visual experience closer to CYNC's clarified position.

Visual character in one statement

> **The CYNC website should feel calm, assured, structured, and substantive, with architectural precision balanced by the warmth of real people, real projects, and direct professional involvement.**

The visual experience should communicate:

- Clarity rather than spectacle
- Confidence rather than luxury
- Structure rather than decoration
- Substance rather than visual density
- Experience without appearing dated
- Technical capability without becoming clinical
- Professionalism without creating distance
- Creativity grounded in purpose

Core visual principles

Evidence over spectacle

Images should help explain CYNC's experience, responsibilities, and project outcomes. They should not exist only to create visual impact.

Structure over ornament

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The design should use hierarchy, alignment, scale, spacing, and contrast to create interest. It should not depend on decorative effects or unnecessary visual treatments.

Restraint with warmth

The website should feel controlled and professional, but not cold. Warmth should come from people, natural materials, contextual photography, and a more conversational rhythm between content and imagery.

Clarity at every scale

The experience must remain understandable and legible across desktop, tablet, and mobile. Editorial ambition should never compromise usability.

Overall visual character

The recommended visual character is:

- Architecturally structured
- Editorial but not fashion-oriented
- Contemporary but not trend-dependent
- Refined without feeling exclusive
- Technical without appearing engineering-heavy
- Restrained but not empty
- Human without becoming informal

The website should resemble the visual expression of an experienced architectural advisor and project leader, not a luxury residential portfolio, a large institutional consultancy, or an experimental design studio.

The overall impression should be that CYNC is thoughtful, composed, and fully in control of the information being presented.

Typography principles

Typography should support clarity, authority, and ease of reading.

The current contrast between a clean sans-serif and an editorial serif style can remain part of the visual system. However, the two type styles should have clearly defined roles.

Primary typeface

A highly legible sans-serif should carry most functional and informational content, including:

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- Navigation
- Body copy
- Service descriptions
- Project information
- Captions
- Buttons
- Forms
- Technical facts
- Footer content

It should feel contemporary, clear, and professional without appearing overly technological.

Secondary typeface

A serif or expressive editorial typeface may be used selectively for:

- Short emphasis
- Section introductions
- Pull quotes
- Project-story transitions
- Carefully chosen brand statements

It should introduce warmth and distinction without becoming the dominant feature of the design.

Typographic guidance

The revised design should:

- Establish a clear and consistent hierarchy
- Use comfortable body-copy sizes
- Maintain sufficient line spacing
- Keep text lines to a readable length
- Use weight and scale deliberately
- Limit the number of type sizes and treatments
- Preserve legibility over photographic backgrounds
- Avoid relying on all-capital text for longer labels
- Avoid excessive letter spacing
- Avoid very thin weights for important information
- Use italic serif typography selectively rather than repeatedly

Typography should make the website easier to understand, not become the subject of attention itself.

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Colour approach

The colour system should reflect CYNC's grounded, quietly confident personality.

A restrained neutral foundation remains appropriate. This may include:

- Deep charcoal
- Warm white
- Soft grey
- Stone
- Slate
- Muted architectural or material tones

The exact colours should be selected during the design phase and tested across digital applications.

A single restrained accent colour may be introduced if it improves hierarchy, interaction, or brand recognition. It should feel connected to CYNC's identity or working environment rather than selected because it is fashionable.

Colour should be used to:

- Establish hierarchy
- Separate information
- Support navigation
- Identify interactive elements
- Improve comprehension
- Create a consistent rhythm between light and dark sections

Colour should not be used to:

- Create unnecessary visual drama
- Compensate for weak content hierarchy
- Apply a different theme to every section
- Place low-contrast text over complex images
- Make the website feel like a luxury lifestyle brand
- Decorate technical information without improving comprehension

The current light and dark contrast can be retained, but transitions should feel intentional and connected to the content.

Layout and composition

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The layout should reflect architectural discipline through clear alignment, proportion, hierarchy, and rhythm.

A strong grid remains appropriate, but it should be flexible enough to accommodate different types of evidence, including:

- Project photography
- Process explanations
- Technical details
- Quotes
- Credentials
- Project facts
- Diagrams
- Team information
- Calls to action

The homepage should establish CYNC's position before asking visitors to interpret a sequence of project images.

Layout principles

- Lead each page with a clear message
- Give related information a visible structure
- Use consistent content widths and alignment
- Create repeatable section patterns
- Alternate visual rhythm without changing the underlying system
- Allow project pages to accommodate different quantities and types of content
- Make important facts easy to scan
- Avoid long passages of centred body copy
- Avoid layouts that depend on a specific image orientation
- Design desktop and mobile as connected experiences rather than separate compositions

The layout should feel composed, but not rigid.

Use of whitespace

Whitespace should create clarity, pace, and emphasis.

It should help the reader:

- Recognize where one idea ends and another begins
- Identify the most important message
- Understand relationships between content elements
- Pause between detailed sections

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- Move comfortably through longer project stories

Whitespace should not be used only to signal luxury or minimalism. Excessive spacing can make substantive content feel fragmented and require unnecessary scrolling.

The revised design should use generous but purposeful spacing. Information should have room to breathe while remaining connected to the content around it.

Photography direction

Photography should function as evidence of CYNC's work and understanding.

The website should use a balanced combination of:

- Completed project photography
- Wider contextual views
- Buildings in use
- Interior and exterior conditions
- Architectural details
- Materials and assemblies
- Construction progress
- Existing conditions
- Operational environments
- Site and landscape relationships

Each project should use photography to communicate its particular story. Not every project needs to look dramatic or highly polished to be valuable.

A facility upgrade, technical renovation, modular addition, or existing-building intervention may be strategically important even when it does not produce conventional portfolio imagery.

Photography should:

- Be connected to verified CYNC work
- Reflect the actual project environment
- Show how facilities are used
- Include captions or project context where helpful
- Identify CYNC's role accurately
- Support the written project narrative
- Be optimized for different screen sizes
- Include appropriate credit where required

Photography should not:

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- Imply that CYNC designed work completed by another firm
- Use unrelated reference imagery as project evidence
- Depend heavily on generic architectural stock photography
- Present only empty, perfected buildings
- Prioritize visual impact over relevance
- Use dark overlays so heavily that the project becomes difficult to see

People and process imagery

The clarified brand position requires more visibility into how CYNC works and who clients will work with.

Appropriate people and process imagery may include:

- Gordon meeting with clients or consultants
- Team discussions
- Site reviews
- Drawing and document reviews
- Existing-condition investigations
- Coordination meetings
- Construction observations
- Material or detail reviews
- Conversations with facility operators
- Work taking place within real project environments

These images should feel observational and authentic rather than staged.

The website does not need a large volume of people photography. A smaller collection of credible images can provide warmth, demonstrate involvement, and reinforce direct access to experienced leadership.

Imagery should avoid:

- Staged handshakes
- Generic boardroom photography
- People pointing at blank screens
- Artificially enthusiastic team poses
- Images that feel disconnected from CYNC's working environment

Technical and contextual imagery

Technical and contextual imagery can help CYNC communicate expertise even when a project does not have dramatic completed photography.

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Relevant material may include:

- Existing-condition photographs
- Site plans
- Floor plans
- Building sections
- Technical details
- Phasing diagrams
- Options comparisons
- Process diagrams
- Material studies
- Annotated construction images
- Before-and-after comparisons
- Permit or coordination drawings
- Commissioning or site-review documentation

Technical imagery should be simplified and prepared for public presentation. Confidential, proprietary, security-sensitive, or client-restricted information should not be published.

The purpose is not to overwhelm visitors with technical detail. It is to make CYNC's thinking and responsibilities visible.

Diagrams and information graphics

Simple diagrams can explain relationships that are difficult to communicate through project photography alone.

Potential uses include:

- CYNC's project process
- The role of the Prime Consultant
- Consultant team coordination
- Project phases
- Decision points
- Options evaluation
- The relationship between scope, budget, operations, and schedule
- Before-and-after facility conditions
- Project facts and outcomes

Diagrams should:

- Communicate one primary idea
- Use consistent symbols and visual language

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- Include clear labels
- Remain understandable without animation
- Work on mobile screens
- Be supported by text where necessary
- Use verified information

They should not become decorative technical drawings that suggest complexity without explaining it.

Motion and interaction principles

Motion should support orientation, hierarchy, and feedback. It should not become a visual performance.

Appropriate uses of motion may include:

- Subtle transitions between states
- Clear menu opening and closing
- Responsive button and link feedback
- Gentle image or content reveals
- Controlled transitions between project information
- Progress indicators for longer pages or galleries

Motion should be:

- Restrained
- Quick
- Consistent
- Optional where appropriate
- Designed to respect reduced-motion preferences
- Tested for performance on mobile devices

The website should avoid:

- Long introductory animations
- Excessive parallax
- Constant movement
- Automatically rotating carousels
- Scroll effects that delay access to content
- Transitions that make navigation feel slower
- Motion that exists only to demonstrate technical capability

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Visitors should feel that the website responds smoothly, not that it asks them to watch it perform.

Accessibility and legibility

Accessibility should be treated as a design requirement from the beginning.

The website should:

- Maintain strong contrast between text and backgrounds
- Use readable type sizes across devices
- Avoid placing essential text directly over visually complex images
- Provide alternative text for meaningful images
- Use descriptive links and buttons
- Provide visible keyboard focus states
- Support keyboard navigation
- Use clear form labels and error messages
- Maintain appropriate touch-target sizes
- Preserve heading hierarchy
- Avoid using colour as the only method of communicating meaning
- Provide captions or transcripts for meaningful video content
- Respect user preferences for reduced motion
- Maintain legibility when text is resized
- Test layouts across common mobile screen sizes

Accessibility supports CYNC's positioning. A website centred on clarity and responsible decision-making must also be clear and usable in practice.

What to retain from the current direction

The following qualities in the current Figma provide a valuable foundation:

- The restrained monochromatic palette
- The use of light and dark sections
- The editorial contrast between sans-serif and serif typography
- The clean architectural grid
- The sense of visual order
- The use of whitespace
- The emphasis on project photography
- The generally restrained interface
- The clear separation of primary website sections
- The intent to create a consistent desktop and mobile experience
- The overall sense of contemporary architectural professionalism

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These elements do not need to be abandoned. They should be refined and redirected to support the clarified narrative.

What to reduce

The revised design should reduce:

- The dominance of project imagery over the business message
- Generic luxury residential cues
- Repeated use of italic serif typography
- Oversized statements that communicate limited substance
- Very small body copy and project details
- Low-contrast text
- Heavy photographic overlays
- Long stretches of imagery without explanation
- Project grids that provide little context
- Repeated generic promotional banners
- Decorative transitions between sections
- Reliance on aspirational or placeholder imagery
- Visual treatments that make every project appear to belong to the same category

Projects should remain visually important, but they should support the story rather than replace it.

What to avoid

The revised design should avoid:

- Repositioning CYNC as a luxury residential studio
- Presenting the website primarily as a visual portfolio
- Generic architecture imagery unrelated to CYNC's work
- Any suggestion that reference projects were completed by CYNC
- Trend-driven effects that may date quickly
- Excessive animation or scroll manipulation
- Decorative technical graphics without informational value
- Overly thin typography
- Dense blocks of small text
- Low-contrast colour combinations
- Text embedded inside images
- Unclear navigation labels
- Hidden or unconventional interactions
- Different visual systems for individual pages
- Claims or project content that cannot be verified

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Visual decision filter

Before a visual element is added or retained, the design team should ask:

1. Does it improve understanding?
2. Does it support a verified CYNC message or project?
3. Does it communicate substance rather than decoration?
4. Does it feel calm, grounded, and quietly confident?
5. Is it legible and usable across screen sizes?
6. Does it help visitors understand why they should trust CYNC?
7. Would the design remain credible if the visual effect were removed?

The revised visual direction should not attempt to make CYNC appear larger, louder, or more fashionable than it is.

It should make the firm's actual strengths more visible: experienced judgment, direct involvement, disciplined coordination, and practical responsibility for complex project outcomes.

Part IV: Website Experience Blueprint

15. Website Objectives

The role of the website

The CYNC website should function as more than a portfolio or digital company profile.

Its primary purpose is to help prospective clients determine whether CYNC is the right architectural partner for a complicated building or facility situation.

The website must communicate what CYNC does, how the firm thinks, what responsibilities it assumes, and why clients can trust it to lead. It should give visitors enough confidence and relevant evidence to begin a professional conversation.

Success should not be measured only by how visually impressive the website appears. It should be measured by whether the right visitors understand CYNC more clearly and feel confident taking the next step.

Primary website objective

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Establish CYNC as an experienced and accountable architectural partner that helps clients understand complex project situations, make sound decisions, and move forward with clear direction.

The intended visitor progression

The website should guide visitors through a simple decision process:

Visitor question	What the website must communicate
Who is CYNC?	A Calgary-based architecture and prime consulting practice
Is CYNC relevant to my situation?	The firm works with complex building, facility, operational, and organizational conditions
How can CYNC help?	By understanding the problem, advising the client, coordinating specialists, and leading delivery
Why should I trust CYNC?	Direct principal involvement, more than 30 years of leadership experience, clear accountability, and relevant project evidence
Has CYNC worked in environments like mine?	Relevant public-sector, educational, institutional, park, industrial, commercial, and existing-building experience
What would it be like to work with CYNC?	Direct, candid, structured, collaborative, and personally led
What should I do next?	Begin a conversation about the project or situation

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Objective 1: Establish confidence quickly

Visitors should understand CYNC's relevance before they are asked to explore individual projects.

The opening experience should communicate:

- That CYNC is an architecture and prime consulting practice
- That the firm helps clients navigate complex building and facility projects
- That clients work directly with experienced leadership
- That CYNC provides clear advice and coordinated project direction
- That the firm works across public, institutional, industrial, development, and private environments

The website should not require visitors to infer CYNC's capabilities from a sequence of photographs.

The opening experience should include:

- A clear primary headline
- A concise description of CYNC's role
- A visible indication of relevant sectors or project environments
- An early reason to believe
- A direct path to services, projects, and contact
- A restrained but distinctive visual identity

The desired first impression is:

> **These people understand complex projects and know how to lead them.**

Objective 2: Explain how CYNC helps

The website must translate CYNC's services into client value.

Visitors may not arrive looking specifically for "prime consulting," "options analysis," or "construction administration." They may arrive because they have:

- An aging facility
- An operational problem
- An uncertain project scope
- A building requiring renewal
- Several technical disciplines to coordinate
- A formal procurement requirement
- A schedule or budget under pressure

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- A project that must proceed within an occupied environment

The website should connect these situations to the services CYNC provides.

It should explain how CYNC helps clients:

- Understand existing conditions
- Define project requirements
- Evaluate options
- Establish priorities
- Assemble specialist expertise
- Coordinate multiple disciplines
- Develop architectural and technical documentation
- Navigate procurement and approvals
- Carry decisions through construction and close-out

The emphasis should remain on the client's situation rather than presenting services as an isolated list of professional tasks.

Objective 3: Demonstrate judgment and experience

The website must make CYNC's experience visible in a way that is relevant to client decisions.

This requires more than displaying the number of years Gordon has practised or listing professional credentials. Visitors should understand how experience influences the work.

The website should demonstrate:

- Direct principal involvement
- The ability to recognize project risks and dependencies
- Experience coordinating technical disciplines
- Understanding of public and institutional processes
- Familiarity with existing buildings and operating facilities
- The ability to distinguish between assumptions and verified conditions
- Attention to practical implementation and long-term performance
- Continuity from early advice through project delivery

Gordon's profile should be a meaningful source of confidence, but the website should connect his history to present-day client value.

Experience should feel active and applied, not historical.

Objective 4: Make complex expertise understandable

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CYNC works within situations that may involve architecture, engineering, operations, procurement, regulation, cost, scheduling, and construction.

The website must explain this complexity without becoming complicated itself.

It should use:

- Plain-language summaries
- Clear content hierarchy
- Short explanations supported by deeper detail
- Simple process diagrams
- Defined project roles
- Structured project facts
- Relevant technical imagery
- Descriptive headings
- Consistent terminology

Visitors should be able to understand the overall value without having technical expertise. Those who need additional detail should be able to find it without overwhelming every other visitor.

Complexity should be communicated as something CYNC can organize and clarify, not as a way to make the firm appear more sophisticated.

Objective 5: Provide relevant evidence

Every important claim should be supported by appropriate evidence.

Evidence may include:

- Completed projects
- Current assignments
- Clearly identified proposed approaches
- Project roles and responsibilities
- Gordon’s credentials and professional history
- Client or organizational context
- Scope and project facts
- Specific challenges addressed
- Consultant teams coordinated
- Decisions or recommendations made
- Verified outcomes
- Testimonials, where available and approved

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Project pages should explain more than what was designed. They should show:

- The situation the client faced
- What made the project complicated
- CYNC's specific role
- How CYNC approached the work
- Which disciplines and stakeholders were involved
- What was delivered
- What practical outcome resulted

The website must clearly distinguish:

- Work completed by CYNC
- Work currently underway
- Experience belonging to Gordon's professional history
- Proposed approaches contained in submissions
- Work completed in collaboration with other firms or consultants

This distinction strengthens credibility and protects the integrity of the brand.

Objective 6: Encourage qualified conversations

The website should prioritize the quality of inquiries rather than the total volume of form submissions.

A qualified visitor should be able to recognize:

- Whether CYNC works within their project environment
- Whether the firm provides the type of leadership required
- Whether CYNC's approach is appropriate for the situation
- Who they will be speaking with
- What information will help begin the conversation
- What is likely to happen after contact

Calls to action should be professional and low pressure.

The primary action should be:

Discuss your project

Supporting actions may include:

- Start a conversation
- Speak with Gordon

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- Tell us what you are working through
- Explore our approach
- View relevant project experience

Contact should be easy from every major page. The process should not feel like entering a sales funnel.

The goal is to begin a useful conversation with an owner, organization, or project leader who values experienced advice and accountable leadership.

Objective 7: Work without depending on spectacular project photography

CYNC's website must remain credible and engaging even when a project is technically important but not conventionally photogenic.

Not every valuable assignment produces dramatic exterior photography. Renovations, assessments, facility upgrades, modular additions, technical coordination, and operational improvements may communicate CYNC's capabilities more accurately than visually spectacular buildings.

The website should therefore support multiple forms of visual evidence:

- Contextual project photography
- Existing conditions
- Buildings in use
- Before-and-after comparisons
- Plans and sections
- Technical details
- Process and phasing diagrams
- Construction photography
- Site-review imagery
- Material and assembly details
- People working and coordinating
- Project facts and outcomes
- Short quotations or recommendations

Page layouts should remain effective when only a limited number of strong images are available.

Photography should support the project story. It should not be responsible for telling the entire story.

Supporting objective: Create a credible validation resource

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Prospective clients may first encounter CYNC through a referral, procurement process, proposal, professional network, or prior relationship.

In these situations, the website functions as a validation resource. Visitors may already know the firm's name but need to confirm:

- What CYNC does
- Which sectors it understands
- Who leads the work
- Whether it can coordinate the required disciplines
- Whether its experience is relevant
- Whether the firm appears active, capable, and credible
- How to make contact

The website should make this information easy to find and verify.

What the website should not become

The website should not become:

- A portfolio that requires visitors to infer CYNC's value
- A luxury residential presentation
- A collection of generic architectural statements
- A technical document written only for architects and engineers
- An exhaustive archive of every project
- A biography focused only on professional history
- A website that appears larger or more complex than the firm
- A highly animated experience that delays access to information
- A lead-generation system designed for maximum inquiry volume
- A substitute for direct conversation

Website success criteria

The revised website should be considered strategically successful when a qualified visitor can:

- Identify what CYNC is
- Understand the situations in which CYNC can help
- Explain CYNC's role in simple language
- Recognize the value of direct principal involvement
- Find evidence relevant to their organization or project
- Understand how CYNC differs from a portfolio-led architecture firm
- Navigate the website without difficulty
- Read and understand the content on any common device

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- Contact CYNC with confidence
- Enter the first conversation with more informed and relevant questions

The website experience should ultimately reinforce one conclusion:

> **CYNC provides the experienced judgment, clear direction, and accountable leadership required to move complex projects forward.**

16. Website Experience Principles

Principles for design and content decisions

The website objectives define what the CYNC website must accomplish. The experience principles define how the website should accomplish it.

These principles should guide decisions throughout content development, information architecture, Figma revision, development, and quality assurance.

When individual preferences or design options compete, the team should select the direction that most clearly supports these principles.

Principle 1: Lead with the client's situation

The website should begin with the conditions clients recognize, not with an extended description of CYNC.

Prospective clients may be facing:

- An aging or underperforming facility
- An unclear project scope
- Competing technical recommendations
- Operational disruption
- Budget or schedule pressure
- Multiple stakeholders and consultants
- Regulatory or procurement requirements
- A need to determine what should happen next

Beginning with these situations demonstrates relevance and helps visitors recognize themselves in the content.

In practice, this means:

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- The homepage opens with a clear client benefit
- Service pages begin with the situations that create a need for the service
- Sector pages address the pressures faced by that audience
- Project stories begin with the client's challenge
- Headings communicate relevance before describing CYNC
- Content connects technical activities to client decisions

The website should still explain who CYNC is, but it should do so in relation to what the client needs.

Principle 2: Make CYNC's judgment visible

Clients cannot evaluate judgment from a finished building image alone.

The website should reveal how CYNC understands a situation, identifies what matters, evaluates information, and recommends a path forward.

In practice, this means:

- Explaining why a particular approach was selected
- Identifying questions that had to be resolved
- Describing relevant constraints and risks
- Showing how existing conditions influenced the work
- Explaining where further investigation was required
- Connecting recommendations to client objectives
- Demonstrating how experience informed a decision
- Including process material where it improves understanding

Project and service content can use a simple decision narrative:

1. What did the client need to understand?
2. What did CYNC examine?
3. What factors influenced the decision?
4. What did CYNC recommend or deliver?
5. What value did that create for the client?

The purpose is not to disclose every technical detail. It is to demonstrate that CYNC's recommendations are informed, deliberate, and connected to the wider project context.

Principle 3: Use projects as evidence

Projects should support CYNC's positioning rather than replace it.

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The website should not depend on visitors examining a gallery and deciding for themselves what CYNC is capable of doing.

Each featured project should provide evidence of one or more strategic strengths, such as:

- Direct principal involvement
- Existing-condition assessment
- Prime Consultant leadership
- Multidisciplinary coordination
- Work within an occupied facility
- Public-sector delivery
- Operational planning
- Regulatory or approval coordination
- Practical problem-solving
- Durable and maintainable outcomes

In practice, this means:

- Selecting projects for strategic relevance, not photography alone
- Identifying CYNC's role clearly
- Explaining what made the project significant
- Including status, sector, scope, and responsibilities
- Connecting the project to a brand pillar
- Presenting verified facts and outcomes
- Crediting consultants and collaborators appropriately
- Distinguishing CYNC projects from Gordon's earlier professional experience

A smaller collection of well-explained projects will communicate more than a large gallery with limited context.

Principle 4: Show people and accountability

Clients should understand who will lead their work and how responsibility will be organized.

Direct principal involvement is one of CYNC's strongest differentiators. The website should make that involvement visible early and reinforce it through the company, service, process, and project content.

In practice, this means:

- Introducing Gordon as Founder and Principal
- Connecting his experience to client value
- Explaining his role during an engagement
- Showing the people responsible for CYNC's work

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- Describing the Prime Consultant relationship
- Explaining how specialist consultants are assembled and coordinated
- Identifying project roles accurately
- Using authentic people and process photography
- Providing a direct and credible contact path

The website should not imply that CYNC performs every discipline internally. It should demonstrate that CYNC knows how to assemble the right expertise and remains accountable for coordinating the complete project response.

Principle 5: Explain complexity simply

CYNC's expertise often involves complex technical and organizational conditions. The website should make those conditions easier to understand.

Complexity should be organized, not displayed for its own sake.

In practice, this means:

- Using plain language before specialist terminology
- Breaking detailed information into clear sections
- Establishing a strong heading hierarchy
- Presenting the conclusion before supporting detail
- Using diagrams when relationships are difficult to explain in prose
- Defining technical terms when they are necessary
- Using project facts and structured summaries
- Allowing visitors to access deeper information progressively
- Maintaining consistent terminology across pages

The website should serve both non-technical decision-makers and technically informed visitors. The main message should be accessible to both, while additional detail remains available to those who need it.

Principle 6: Provide clear next steps

Visitors should understand what they can do from every major point in the website.

Calls to action should be relevant to the content around them and should set a clear expectation.

In practice, this means:

- Using one consistent primary call to action
- Providing a clear route to contact from every major page

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- Using descriptive links instead of repeated “Learn more” buttons
- Connecting service pages to relevant projects
- Connecting project pages to CYNC’s services and contact information
- Making contact details easy to find
- Explaining who will respond
- Keeping the inquiry process concise
- Avoiding unnecessary form fields

The primary call to action should be:

Discuss your project

Supporting calls to action may include:

- Explore our approach
- View relevant projects
- See CYNC’s role
- Meet the project lead
- Speak with Gordon
- Start a conversation

The experience should invite a professional discussion without applying artificial urgency or sales pressure.

Principle 7: Design mobile experiences through prioritization, not compression

The mobile website should not be a desktop layout made narrower.

Mobile design requires deliberate decisions about sequence, hierarchy, interaction, image use, and the amount of information presented at each stage.

In practice, this means:

- Reconsidering content order for smaller screens
- Placing the primary message and action early
- Maintaining readable typography
- Reformatting grids rather than shrinking them
- Avoiding very small project details
- Replacing complex hover interactions with clear touch interactions
- Ensuring buttons and links are easy to select
- Simplifying diagrams without removing their meaning
- Using images at sizes that remain useful
- Avoiding horizontal content that appears accidentally cropped
- Keeping forms short and easy to complete

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- Managing page length through hierarchy rather than deleting essential content
- Optimizing media for mobile performance
- Testing navigation and content on actual devices

Prioritization does not mean removing the evidence that builds confidence. It means presenting that evidence in the order and format most useful to a mobile visitor.

Principle 8: Use real and verified content

The credibility of the website depends on the accuracy of its content.

Every project, role, credential, statistic, testimonial, image, and outcome should be reviewed before publication.

In practice, this means:

- Using photography from verified CYNC projects
- Confirming that CYNC has permission to publish each image
- Identifying CYNC's actual project role
- Distinguishing completed, current, and proposed work
- Separating CYNC's company experience from Gordon's earlier professional experience
- Confirming project names, clients, locations, dates, budgets, and status
- Crediting collaborators where appropriate
- Obtaining approval for testimonials
- Avoiding confidential or security-sensitive information
- Removing placeholder copy and reference imagery before launch
- Maintaining a record of content sources and approvals

The website should never imply that CYNC completed a project or performed a responsibility that belonged to another firm.

Accuracy is not only a legal or administrative requirement. It is part of CYNC's quietly confident and accountable brand position.

How the principles work together

The principles create a connected website experience:

1. Begin with a situation the client recognizes.
2. Explain how CYNC thinks and helps.
3. Demonstrate the approach through relevant projects.
4. Show who is responsible for leading the work.
5. Make complex information easy to understand.
6. Offer a clear and appropriate next step.

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7. preserve the hierarchy and meaning on mobile devices.
8. Support every important claim with verified content.

Experience decision checklist

Before approving a page, section, or interaction, the project team should ask:

- Does it begin with something relevant to the intended visitor?
- Does it explain CYNC's contribution clearly?
- Does it make judgment or accountability visible?
- Is the supporting evidence relevant and verified?
- Can the information be understood without specialist knowledge?
- Is the next step clear?
- Does the mobile version reflect deliberate prioritization?
- Does the experience remain effective without relying on a spectacular image?
- Does it support the perception that CYNC knows what it is doing?

If the answer to these questions is yes, the experience is likely aligned with the website strategy.

17. Sitemap and Navigation

Recommended information architecture

The CYNC website should use a focused and relatively shallow structure.

Visitors should be able to understand what CYNC does, find relevant evidence, learn who will lead their project, and begin a conversation without navigating through unnecessary layers.

The recommended launch sitemap consists of five primary destinations, supported by individual project-story pages and essential utility pages.

Recommended launch sitemap

Level	Page	Recommended URL	Launch status	Primary purpose
Primary	Home	/	Required	Establish CYNC's position, relevance,

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				evidence, and primary next step
Primary	Services	`/services`	Required	Explain how CYNC helps and connect services to client situations
Primary	Projects	`/projects`	Required	Present selected projects as evidence of experience and capability
Secondary	Individual Project Story	`/projects/project-name`	Required template	Explain the situation, CYNC's role, approach, coordination, and outcome
Primary	About	`/about`	Required	Introduce CYNC, Gordon, the team, operating principles, and leadership model
Primary	Contact	`/contact`	Required	Help qualified prospective clients begin a direct conversation
Conditional	Insights	`/insights`	Deferred pending confirmation	Share useful professional perspectives and

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				demonstrate applied judgment
Conditional	Individual Insight	`/insights/article-name`	Deferred pending confirmation	Present an individual article or professional commentary
Utility	Privacy Policy	`/privacy`	Required if forms or analytics are used	Explain the collection and use of visitor information
Utility	Form Confirmation	Inline or `/thank-you`	Required	Confirm that an inquiry has been received and explain what happens next
Utility	Page Not Found	System route	Required	Help visitors recover from an incorrect or outdated link
Utility	Accessibility	`/accessibility`	Recommended	Communicate CYNC's commitment to an accessible digital experience

Recommended navigation structure

Desktop navigation

- Services
- Projects
- About
- Contact

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The CYNC logo should link to Home. A separate Home link is not required in the desktop navigation if that behaviour is clear and conventional.

If Insights is approved and launched with meaningful content, it may be added between About and Contact:

- Services
- Projects
- About
- Insights
- Contact

Contact should remain visually identifiable as the primary action, but it should not feel aggressive or overly promotional.

Mobile navigation

- Home
- Services
- Projects
- About
- Contact

If Insights is active:

- Home
- Services
- Projects
- About
- Insights
- Contact

Home should appear explicitly in the mobile menu because the logo and menu may not remain visible together throughout every interaction.

Footer navigation

The footer should provide:

- Home
- Services
- Projects
- About
- Contact

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- Insights, if active
- Privacy Policy
- Accessibility, if included
- Verified social media links
- Direct contact information
- Office address
- Copyright information

Only active and maintained social channels should be included.

Navigation labels and page titles

Navigation labels should be familiar and immediately understandable. More expressive language can be used within the page itself.

Navigation label	Recommended page title	Reasoning
Services	How CYNC Helps	“Services” is easy to recognize in navigation, while the page title can shift the focus toward client needs
Projects	Project Stories	“Projects” supports fast navigation, while “Project Stories” establishes that the content will explain more than appearance
About	About CYNC	Clear, conventional, and specific
Insights	Insights from Practice	Positions the content as useful professional knowledge rather than company news
Contact	Discuss Your Project	Keeps navigation direct while making the page invitation more purposeful

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The navigation should prioritize usability. Visitors should not have to interpret labels such as “Practice,” “Thinking,” “Explore,” or “Discover” to understand where a link will take them.

Home

The Home page should provide a concise overview of the complete CYNC position.

It should answer:

- What is CYNC?
- What kinds of situations does CYNC help with?
- How does CYNC work?
- Why should a prospective client have confidence in the firm?
- What evidence is available?
- Who leads the work?
- What should the visitor do next?

The Home page should not attempt to reproduce every section of the website. It should establish the narrative and guide visitors toward Services, Projects, About, or Contact based on their interest.

Services

Recommended navigation label: Services
Recommended page title: How CYNC Helps

A single Services page is recommended for the initial launch.

It should organize CYNC’s capabilities around client needs rather than creating several thin service pages with repetitive content.

Recommended service groups include:

1. Project Definition and Advisory
2. Prime Consulting and Project Leadership
3. Architectural Design and Documentation
4. Existing Building Renewal
5. Tendering and Procurement Support
6. Construction Administration and Close-Out

The page should also explain:

- The situations that create a need for each service
- What CYNC does

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- How the client benefits
- How the services connect across the project lifecycle
- Which project stories provide relevant evidence

Separate service pages can be introduced later if CYNC develops enough distinct content, evidence, or search visibility requirements to support them.

Projects

Recommended navigation label: Projects
Recommended page title: Project Stories

The Projects page should act as an evidence library rather than a conventional image gallery.

It should:

- Introduce CYNC's approach to project work
- Present a carefully selected collection of relevant projects
- Make project roles and status visible
- Allow visitors to identify work relevant to their environment
- Connect projects to services and brand pillars
- Provide access to individual project stories

Project filters should be used only if CYNC has enough verified projects to make each category meaningful.

Potential categories may include:

- Public and Institutional
- Education
- Existing Building Renewal
- Industrial and Technical
- Development and Private-Sector Work

Final categories should be based on the verified project inventory. Empty or weak categories should not be created simply to suggest breadth.

Individual Project Story

Each project should use one flexible page template rather than a completely different layout.

The template should accommodate:

- Project headline

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- Concise project summary
- Client or owner
- Location
- Project status
- CYNC's role
- Scope and services
- Project team
- Original client situation
- Project complexity
- CYNC's approach
- Important decisions or recommendations
- Delivery process
- Verified outcome
- Photography and technical imagery
- Related services
- Related project stories
- Relevant call to action

The template should work for:

- Completed projects
- Current assignments
- Projects with limited photography
- Existing-building work
- Technical projects
- Work from Gordon's earlier professional history, when clearly identified
- Projects completed in collaboration with other firms

Current work, proposed work, and completed work must not be presented as equivalent.

About

Recommended navigation label: About
Recommended page title: About CYNC

The About page should explain:

- Why CYNC exists
- What the firm believes about complex projects
- How CYNC approaches its responsibilities
- Gordon's role and professional history
- Direct principal involvement
- The wider CYNC team

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- How specialist consultants are assembled
- CYNC's values and operating principles
- The environments in which CYNC works

The About page should not rely primarily on a general studio description and a grid of team photographs. It should give prospective clients a clear understanding of who will lead their work and what working with CYNC will feel like.

A separate Team page is not required for the initial launch. Team profiles can remain part of About unless the firm grows to the point where a dedicated directory becomes useful.

A Careers page should not be included unless CYNC is actively recruiting and can provide meaningful information about available opportunities.

Contact

Recommended navigation label: Contact
Recommended page title: Discuss Your Project

The Contact page should provide:

- A concise invitation to begin a conversation
- Gordon or CYNC's primary contact information
- Office address
- A short inquiry form
- An explanation of what information is helpful
- A clear indication of what happens after submission
- Links to verified professional or social channels

Recommended form fields include:

- Name
- Organization
- Email
- Phone, optional
- Project location, optional
- Brief description of the project or situation
- Preferred method of contact, optional

The form should remain short. Its purpose is to begin a conversation, not to qualify the entire project before CYNC responds.

Resolving Blog, Studio Journal, or Insights

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The current Figma navigation includes a Blog link. The signed project scope calls for sitemap and wireframe design for core pages, but it does not specifically identify a Blog, Studio Journal, or Insights section as a required deliverable.

The presence of Blog in the initial Figma should therefore be treated as an early design assumption rather than a confirmed strategic requirement.

Blog

“Blog” is familiar, but it is broad and creates an expectation of frequent publication. It may also encourage a mixture of company announcements, project updates, and general articles without a clear editorial purpose.

Recommendation: Do not use “Blog” as the final label.

Studio Journal

“Studio Journal” has a more editorial and design-oriented character. However, it can make CYNC sound like a boutique design studio focused on culture, inspiration, and visual exploration.

This is not the strongest match for the clarified position of experienced judgment, practical leadership, and client-focused guidance.

Recommendation: Do not use “Studio Journal.”

Insights

“Insights” is the most appropriate label if CYNC intends to publish useful professional content.

It can accommodate:

- Guidance on defining a project before design begins
- Existing-building and facility-renewal considerations
- Prime Consultant responsibilities
- Multidisciplinary coordination
- Public procurement and project preparation
- Operational planning during renovation
- Lifecycle, durability, and maintainability
- Lessons from completed work
- Changes affecting building owners and public organizations

The content should help clients understand a project issue or make a better decision. It should not exist only to keep the website active.

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Recommendation for launch

> **Do not include Insights in the primary launch navigation unless CYNC approves an editorial commitment and has sufficient content ready for publication.**

Insights should be included at launch only if CYNC can confirm:

- A clear purpose for the section
- A named person responsible for content
- A review and approval process
- At least three substantive launch articles
- A realistic publication cadence
- Topics connected to CYNC's priority audiences
- The ability to maintain accuracy over time

If these conditions are not met, Insights should be removed from the launch navigation and reserved for a later phase.

The website design may anticipate the future addition of Insights without displaying an empty or inactive section.

Recommended launch navigation decision

The recommended launch navigation is:

> **Services | Projects | About | Contact**

Home is accessed through the CYNC logo on desktop and appears explicitly in the mobile menu.

Insights may be added later when CYNC has the content and internal capacity required to make the section credible.

Sitemap principles

The final sitemap should remain guided by the following principles:

- Use familiar navigation labels
- Keep the number of primary destinations limited
- Avoid thin or repetitive pages
- Organize services around client needs
- Organize projects around relevant evidence
- Keep team and operating principles within About
- Add Insights only when it can be maintained
- Give every page a clear next step

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- Ensure the same information architecture works across desktop and mobile
- Design for future expansion without presenting unfinished content

This structure gives CYNC a focused launch website while allowing services, project stories, sectors, and Insights to expand as the available content grows.

18. Page-by-Page Experience Blueprint

Purpose of the blueprint

This section translates the website strategy into a recommended content hierarchy for each page.

The sequences define what visitors should understand and in what order. They do not prescribe final layouts. The design team may explore different compositions in Figma provided that the hierarchy, evidence, and intended visitor journey remain intact.

All proposed headlines are working language. They should be refined during content development and approved before implementation.

18.1 Home

Page purpose

Establish CYNC's relevance and credibility quickly, communicate the firm's position, introduce its approach, and direct visitors toward appropriate evidence or contact.

The Home page should provide a clear overview without attempting to reproduce every section of the website.

Primary audience

- Municipal and public-agency decision-makers
- School board and institutional representatives
- Healthcare facility leaders
- Industrial and technical organizations
- Developers and property owners
- Prospective clients referred to Gordon or CYNC
- Consultants and project partners evaluating the firm

Visitor question

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Who is CYNC, can they help with a project like ours, and why should we trust them?

Primary message

CYNC brings clear direction to complex building and facility projects.

Supporting message:

We help clients understand the situation, make sound decisions, coordinate the right expertise, and carry a practical response from early assessment through design and delivery.

Recommended section sequence

1. Hero and primary proposition

Immediately establish:

- What CYNC is
- What kind of situations the firm addresses
- The principal client benefit
- The primary next step

Working headline:

Clear direction for complex building projects.

Primary action:

Discuss your project

Secondary action:

Explore our approach

2. Recognition of the client situation

Introduce the conditions that often bring clients to CYNC:

- Aging or underperforming facilities
- Unclear project requirements
- Several technical disciplines
- Operational constraints
- Formal approvals and procurement
- Budget and schedule pressures

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- A need to determine what should happen next

Working headline:

> Some projects begin with a design brief. Others begin with a problem that still needs to be understood.

3. How CYNC helps

Introduce the four brand pillars:

- Clarity Before Design
- Judgment Grounded in Experience
- Accountable Leadership and Coordination
- Practical Outcomes Built for the Long Term

Each pillar should link to the relevant Services or About content.

Working headline:

> Understand first. Then establish the right path forward.

4. Services overview

Present CYNC's services as a connected project journey:

1. Project Definition and Advisory
2. Prime Consulting and Project Leadership
3. Architectural Design and Documentation
4. Existing Building Renewal
5. Tendering and Procurement Support
6. Construction Administration and Close-Out

Working headline:

> Support from early questions through project delivery.

5. Relevant project evidence

Feature a small number of strategically selected projects.

Each feature should identify:

- Project situation
- CYNC's role

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- Sector
- Status
- One meaningful outcome or responsibility

Working headline:

Experience applied to real project conditions.

6. Prime Consultant leadership

Explain CYNC's role in assembling and coordinating the appropriate disciplines.

A simple diagram may show:

- Client
- CYNC as Prime Consultant
- Specialist consultants
- Contractors and authorities
- Coordinated project outcome

Working headline:

One accountable lead. The right expertise around the table.

7. Direct principal involvement

Introduce Gordon, his credentials, and what direct involvement means for clients.

Working headline:

Experienced leadership remains involved.

This section should link to About.

8. Client perspective

Include one verified testimonial or client observation, if available and approved.

The testimonial should reinforce:

- Judgment
- Responsiveness
- Clarity
- Coordination
- Trust

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- Follow-through

If a meaningful testimonial is not available, this section should be omitted rather than filled with a generic quotation.

9. Optional future Insights preview

Include only if Insights is approved and active.

Feature no more than three relevant articles.

Working headline:

> Insights from practice.

10. Closing invitation

Return to the visitor's situation and offer a direct next step.

Working headline:

> Need clarity on what comes next?

Call to action:

> Discuss your project

Required proof

- Gordon's verified professional credentials
- Confirmed statement of more than 30 years of experience
- Completed and current project examples
- Accurate project roles and status
- Evidence of Prime Consultant responsibilities
- Approved testimonial, if used
- Verified sector experience
- Authentic CYNC project imagery

Suggested working headlines

- Clear direction for complex building projects.
- Start with the right questions.
- Experience applied where decisions matter.
- One accountable lead.
- Projects shaped by real operating conditions.

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- Practical decisions with long-term value.
- Need clarity on what comes next?

Calls to action

Primary: Discuss your project
Secondary: Explore our approach

Supporting links may include:

- View project stories
- See how CYNC helps
- Meet Gordon

Imagery direction

Use a balanced mix of:

- Contextual project photography
- Buildings in use
- Existing conditions
- Technical details
- Site and coordination activity
- Gordon or the team working
- Simple project or process diagrams

The hero should not depend on an unrelated spectacular building. The opening message must remain effective even if the image is modest or process-oriented.

Required client content

- Approved company description
- Confirmed service list
- Priority project selection
- Project facts and permissions
- Gordon’s approved biography
- Team information
- Approved photography
- Testimonials, if available
- Verified social and contact information

Mobile considerations

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- Keep the primary proposition visible immediately
- Place the primary call to action early
- Reduce hero-image height where necessary
- Present brand pillars as a vertical sequence
- Avoid horizontally compressed service cards
- Show project roles and status without requiring interaction
- Simplify the Prime Consultant diagram
- Maintain readable project facts
- Avoid long introductory animations
- Keep the route to Contact consistently available

18.2 Services

Page purpose

Explain how CYNC helps clients and connect professional services to the situations, decisions, and project stages that create a need for them.

Primary audience

- Owners defining a potential project
- Public-sector procurement and facility representatives
- Institutional facility leaders
- Organizations requiring a Prime Consultant
- Existing clients evaluating a new assignment
- Referral-based visitors confirming CYNC's capabilities

Visitor question

> Can CYNC provide the leadership and services our situation requires?

Primary message

> **CYNC helps clients define the problem, establish the right project response, coordinate the necessary expertise, and carry decisions through delivery.**

Recommended section sequence

1. Service proposition

Introduce CYNC's services through client value.

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How CYNC helps.

2. Situations that create a need

Present recognizable client situations such as:

- The project scope is not yet clear
- Existing conditions require investigation
- The facility must remain operational
- Several consultants must be coordinated
- The work requires formal approvals or procurement
- An existing building needs renewal or adaptation
- A project needs experienced construction-phase support

Working headline:

The right service begins with the situation.

3. Project Definition and Advisory

Explain assessment, feasibility, options analysis, performance criteria, and project definition.

Working headline:

Define what needs to be solved.

4. Prime Consulting and Project Leadership

Explain the single point of accountability and consultant coordination model.

Working headline:

Bring the right expertise together.

5. Architectural Design and Documentation

Explain how CYNC connects architectural decisions with technical, operational, regulatory, and construction requirements.

Working headline:

Design from an informed position.

6. Existing Building Renewal

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Explain renovation, modernization, lifecycle renewal, additions, accessibility, envelope, and system integration.

Working headline:

Work with the realities already in place.

7. Tendering and Procurement Support

Explain coordinated documentation, bidder questions, addenda, bid review, and recommendations.

Working headline:

Move into procurement with clear information.

8. Construction Administration and Close-Out

Explain how CYNC remains involved through construction, commissioning coordination, deficiencies, and completion.

Working headline:

Carry project decisions through delivery.

9. Project lifecycle

Show how the service areas connect.

The diagram should clarify that not every engagement begins or ends at the same stage.

Working headline:

Support matched to the project.

10. Relevant project evidence

Connect service groups to selected project stories.

11. Closing invitation

Working headline:

Not sure where the engagement should begin?

Call to action:

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Discuss your requirements

Required proof

- Confirmed service descriptions
- Examples supporting each major service
- Evidence of Prime Consultant work
- Current and completed project responsibilities
- Relevant process or technical materials
- Accurate limits around specialist services
- Confirmation of whether interior design is a priority service

Suggested working headlines

- How CYNC helps.
- Define what needs to be solved.
- The right team for the actual requirements.
- Design from an informed position.
- Coordinate the complete project response.
- Carry decisions through construction.
- Support matched to the project.

Calls to action

Primary: Discuss your requirements
Secondary: View relevant projects

Imagery direction

Use:

- Existing-condition reviews
- Plans and drawings
- Coordination activity
- Site-review photography
- Technical details
- Project-phase diagrams
- Completed project evidence

Avoid assigning a decorative image to every service simply to fill space.

Required client content

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- Approved service names
- Activities included within each service
- Services not offered directly by CYNC
- Specialist disciplines commonly coordinated
- Representative projects for each service
- Process documents suitable for public presentation
- Confirmation of service terminology

Mobile considerations

- Present service areas vertically
- Use concise summaries before detailed content
- Allow optional expansion for supporting activities
- Keep the project lifecycle diagram readable
- Avoid nested carousels
- Place related project evidence after the relevant service
- Maintain an accessible contact action throughout the page

18.3 Projects

Page purpose

Provide a curated evidence library demonstrating CYNC's experience, roles, judgment, and relevance across different project environments.

Primary audience

- Prospective clients looking for comparable experience
- Procurement teams validating qualifications
- Referral-based visitors confirming credibility
- Consultants and project partners
- Prospective employees, as a secondary audience

Visitor question

> Has CYNC worked in situations relevant to ours, and what role did the firm perform?

Primary message

> **CYNC's projects demonstrate how the firm understands complex conditions, coordinates project teams, and carries practical decisions into delivery.**

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Recommended section sequence

1. Projects introduction

Working headline:

Project stories.

Supporting copy should explain that the collection is organized around client situations and CYNC's contribution, not visual style alone.

2. Featured project

Present one strong and well-documented project with:

- Client situation
- CYNC's role
- Sector
- Status
- Principal challenge
- Outcome
- Link to the complete story

3. Project categories or filters

Use only if supported by sufficient verified content.

Potential categories include:

- Public and Institutional
- Education
- Existing Building Renewal
- Industrial and Technical
- Development and Private-Sector Work

4. Project-story collection

Each project card should include:

- Project name
- Location
- Year or status
- CYNC's role
- Sector or project context
- One short relevance statement

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- Verified image

5. Evidence beyond completed photography

Introduce projects that demonstrate technical or leadership capability even when they have limited visual material.

Working headline:

Not every important project is defined by its final photograph.

6. Closing invitation

Working headline:

Looking for experience relevant to your project?

Call to action:

Discuss your project

Required proof

- Verified project inventory
- Project status
- CYNC's exact role
- Client and location
- Dates and budget where publishable
- Scope and services
- Outcomes
- Image ownership and publication permission
- Collaborator credits
- Confirmation of projects belonging to Gordon's earlier experience

Suggested working headlines

- Project stories.
- Experience across real project conditions.
- Work defined by more than building type.
- The situation behind the solution.
- Projects that demonstrate how CYNC works.

Calls to action

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Primary: Discuss your project
Secondary: Explore our services

Project-card action:

View project story

Imagery direction

Use consistent but flexible image treatment.

Projects with limited photography may use:

- Existing-condition images
- Plans
- Sections
- Technical details
- Construction progress
- Material studies
- Diagrams
- Contextual photographs

Do not use unrelated reference imagery as a substitute.

Required client content

- Complete project list
- Priority projects
- Project categorization
- Verified metadata
- Project summaries
- High-resolution images
- Image credits and permissions
- Status and role confirmation
- Confidentiality restrictions

Mobile considerations

- Use a single-column project sequence
- Make filters easy to open, use, and clear
- Do not depend on hover states
- Keep roles and status visible
- Use appropriate image crops for each project

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- Avoid horizontally clipped project grids
- Allow visitors to return easily to the same list position

18.4 Individual Project Story

Page purpose

Demonstrate CYNC's relevance and credibility through a complete account of a project situation, the firm's role, its approach, and the resulting outcome.

Primary audience

- Prospective clients evaluating comparable experience
- Procurement and selection committees
- Existing clients considering another engagement
- Project partners
- Technically informed reviewers

Visitor question

> What did CYNC contribute, how did the firm approach the work, and why is this project relevant to us?

Primary message

The primary message will vary by project, but should follow this structure:

> **CYNC helped the client address [project situation] by [principal contribution], resulting in [verified outcome].**

Recommended section sequence

1. Project introduction

Include:

- Project name
- Descriptive project headline
- Location
- Sector
- Status
- Principal image or contextual visual

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The headline should describe the project's significance rather than repeat its name.

2. Project at a glance

Include:

- Client or owner
- CYNC's role
- Project type
- Scope
- Status
- Completion date
- Budget, where publishable
- Key consultant disciplines

3. The client situation

Explain what created the need for the project.

Working headline:

> The situation.

4. What made the project complex

Identify relevant conditions such as:

- Existing facilities
- Ongoing operations
- Public access
- Technical systems
- Multiple sites
- Compressed schedule
- Procurement
- Approvals
- Seasonal limitations
- Budget
- Stakeholders

Working headline:

> What the project required.

5. CYNC's role

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Explain CYNC's responsibilities precisely.

Working headline:

CYNC's responsibility.

6. The approach and key decisions

Describe:

- What CYNC reviewed
- What had to be clarified
- What options or constraints were considered
- What CYNC recommended
- How the response developed

Working headline:

Establishing the path forward.

7. Coordination and delivery

Explain how disciplines, stakeholders, authorities, and contractors were coordinated.

Working headline:

Coordinating the complete response.

8. Visual and technical evidence

Use photography, drawings, details, diagrams, and factual annotations to support the narrative.

9. Outcome

Present only verified results.

Working headline:

The outcome.

10. Related projects and services

Connect the story to relevant capabilities without interrupting the main narrative.

11. Closing invitation

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Working headline:

Working through a similar project situation?

Call to action:

Start a conversation

Required proof

- Project name and location
- Client permission
- CYNC's exact role
- Project status and dates
- Scope and budget
- Key client situation
- Relevant constraints
- CYNC's actions and recommendations
- Consultant and collaborator credits
- Verified outcomes
- Photography rights
- Confidentiality review

Suggested working headlines

- Renewing five public-use buildings within an active seasonal park.
- Coordinating additions across occupied school sites.
- Understanding the existing system before selecting a solution.
- Working with the conditions already in place.
- Establishing a coordinated path through delivery.

Calls to action

Primary: Start a conversation
Secondary: View related projects

Imagery direction

Create a visual narrative using:

- Site context
- Existing conditions
- Project in use

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- Construction
- Technical details
- Drawings and diagrams
- Completed work
- People and process

The page should remain effective with a limited image collection.

Required client content

A completed project-content worksheet for every published story, including:

- Facts
- Narrative
- Role
- Status
- Outcomes
- Images
- Credits
- Permissions
- Confidentiality restrictions
- Client quotation, if available

Mobile considerations

- Present essential project facts near the top
- Keep long project data readable
- Use full-width images selectively
- Provide captions outside image overlays
- Simplify diagrams
- Avoid image galleries requiring precise gestures
- Maintain clear movement between story sections
- Place related projects after the outcome
- Keep the contact action accessible without interrupting the story

18.5 About

Page purpose

Explain who CYNC is, what the firm believes, who leads the work, and what clients can expect from the relationship.

Primary audience

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- Prospective clients evaluating trust and fit
- Referral-based visitors
- Procurement teams
- Consultants and collaborators
- Prospective employees, as a secondary audience

Visitor question

> Who will we be working with, what does CYNC stand for, and how does the firm operate?

Primary message

> **CYNC combines direct principal involvement, experienced judgment, and accountable project leadership to help clients navigate complex building and facility decisions.**

Recommended section sequence

1. Company introduction

Working headline:

> About CYNC.

Use the approved short company narrative.

2. What CYNC believes

Introduce the central belief:

> Understand the problem before prescribing the solution.

Explain how this shapes the firm's work.

3. Gordon Murray

Present:

- Founder and Principal role
- Professional credentials
- More than 30 years of experience
- Relevant leadership history
- Present responsibilities

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- What direct involvement means for clients

Working headline:

Experienced leadership, directly involved.

4. The CYNC team

Introduce current team members through:

- Role
- Responsibilities
- Credentials
- Relevant expertise
- Connection to client delivery

Avoid generic personal biographies unless they add value.

5. The wider consultant model

Explain how CYNC assembles specialist teams around project requirements.

Working headline:

The right expertise for the assignment.

6. Values and operating principles

Present the six principles concisely:

- Candour
- Accountability
- Practical Judgment
- Stewardship
- Coordinated Collaboration
- Purposeful Thoroughness

Working headline:

How CYNC works.

7. Experience and project environments

Present verified experience across relevant sectors while distinguishing company and individual history.

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8. Closing invitation

Working headline:

Work directly with the people responsible for the project.

Call to action:

Discuss your project

Required proof

- Gordon's biography and credentials
- Confirmed professional timeline
- Current team names, roles, and credentials
- Professional headshots
- Verified sector experience
- Description of direct principal involvement
- Consultant-team model
- Approved company history
- Accurate distinction between CYNC and prior-firm experience

Suggested working headlines

- About CYNC.
- Experienced leadership, directly involved.
- Understand before recommending.
- The right expertise for the assignment.
- Accountability remains with CYNC.
- How CYNC works.
- Experience connected to present responsibilities.

Calls to action

Primary: Discuss your project
Secondary: View project stories

Imagery direction

Use:

- Authentic portraits
- Gordon and team members working
- Site reviews

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- Coordination activity
- Drawings and physical materials
- Project environments
- Limited but meaningful studio imagery

Avoid relying entirely on formal headshots or a conventional team grid.

Required client content

- Approved company history
- Gordon’s biography
- Team biographies
- Professional credentials
- Portraits
- Process imagery
- Values approval
- Confirmation of sector experience
- Consultant-partner description
- Recruitment information only if currently relevant

Mobile considerations

- Introduce the core belief before long company history
- Give Gordon’s role and experience early visibility
- Present team profiles in a vertical sequence
- Keep credentials readable
- Avoid small portrait grids
- Condense values without reducing them to unsupported labels
- Move optional historical detail below current capabilities
- Keep the contact action available after leadership and values

18.6 Insights

Status: Future consideration only. This blueprint is included as a strategic framework and is not part of the current Figma revision.

Page purpose

Demonstrate CYNC’s applied judgment by publishing useful professional perspectives relevant to client decisions.

Primary audience

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- Owners and facility leaders researching a project issue
- Existing clients
- Public and institutional decision-makers
- Consultants and industry partners
- Search visitors looking for specific guidance

Visitor question

> Does CYNC understand the issues affecting projects like ours, and can the firm explain them clearly?

Primary message

> **Practical perspectives on building, facility, and project decisions.**

Recommended section sequence

1. Insights introduction

Working headline:

> Insights from practice.

2. Featured insight

Present one timely and substantive article.

3. Topic categories

Potential topics include:

- Project Definition
- Existing Buildings
- Prime Consulting
- Public Projects
- Operational Facilities
- Procurement and Delivery
- Lifecycle and Maintainability

4. Article collection

Each article card should include:

- Clear title
- Short summary

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- Author
- Publication date
- Topic
- Reading time, optional

5. Professional invitation

Working headline:

Working through a related question?

Call to action:

Discuss it with CYNC

Required proof

- At least three approved launch articles
- Named author
- Publication and review dates
- Verified technical content
- Supporting sources where required
- Approved imagery
- Editorial owner
- Content review process

Suggested working headlines

- Insights from practice.
- Questions worth resolving before design begins.
- Working with existing-building uncertainty.
- What owners should expect from a Prime Consultant.
- Planning renovation around ongoing operations.

Calls to action

Primary: Discuss it with CYNC
Secondary: Read the latest insight

Imagery direction

Use:

- Relevant project context

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- Diagrams
- Technical details
- Process imagery
- Original illustrations
- Restrained portraits or author images

Avoid generic blog stock photography.

Required client content

- Editorial plan
- Initial articles
- Author biographies
- Review responsibilities
- Publication cadence
- Topic categories
- Image permissions
- Source and citation standards

Mobile considerations

- Make article titles and summaries easy to scan
- Avoid dense multi-column layouts
- Keep category filters simple
- Show dates and authors clearly
- Do not use oversized featured imagery that delays access to content

18.7 Individual Insight

Status: Future consideration only. This blueprint is included as a strategic framework and is not part of the current Figma revision.

Page purpose

Present a useful professional perspective in a clear, credible, and readable format.

Primary audience

Readers researching a specific building, facility, or project-management question.

Visitor question

> What should we understand about this issue, and how might it affect our project?

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Primary message

The message should be specific to the subject and provide a useful conclusion rather than a promotional introduction.

Recommended section sequence

1. Article title
2. Concise summary
3. Author and publication information
4. The client situation
5. Key considerations
6. CYNC's professional perspective
7. Practical implications
8. Related project or service
9. Related insights
10. Contact invitation

Required proof

- Identified author
- Verified facts
- Appropriate sources
- Publication date
- Review date
- Relevant CYNC experience
- Clear distinction between general information and project-specific advice

Suggested working headline patterns

- What owners should confirm before…
- When an existing facility requires…
- Five questions to ask before…
- How operational requirements affect…
- What a Prime Consultant coordinates during…

Calls to action

Primary: Discuss your situation
Secondary: Explore related insights

Imagery direction

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Use diagrams, project context, technical details, and original supporting visuals. Images should help explain the subject.

Required client content

- Completed article
- Author approval
- Technical review
- Sources
- Supporting visuals
- Related service and project links
- Review schedule

Mobile considerations

- Use a readable article width
- Maintain clear heading hierarchy
- Include a concise summary near the top
- Make tables responsive
- Provide captions outside images
- Avoid intrusive contact prompts
- Keep related content after the article conclusion

18.8 Contact

Page purpose

Make it easy for a qualified prospective client to begin a direct and informed conversation with CYNC.

Primary audience

- Prospective clients
- Existing clients
- Project partners
- Referral-based visitors
- Procurement contacts

Visitor question

How do I contact CYNC, who will respond, and what information should I provide?

Primary message

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Tell us what you are working through.

Supporting message:

Whether you have a defined project or are still determining what needs to happen next, CYNC welcomes an initial conversation.

Recommended section sequence

1. Contact invitation

Working headline:

Discuss your project.

2. Direct contact information

Provide:

- Primary email
- Telephone number
- Office address
- Primary contact
- Working hours, if useful

3. Inquiry form

Recommended fields:

- Name
- Organization
- Email
- Phone, optional
- Project location, optional
- Brief description of the project or situation
- Preferred contact method, optional

4. What happens next

Explain:

- Who reviews the inquiry
- How CYNC will respond
- What the first conversation may cover
- That detailed project information is not required at this stage

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Working headline:

What to expect.

5. Office and professional links

Include a map only if it is genuinely useful. Provide verified LinkedIn or other professional links.

Required proof

- Correct contact details
- Gordon's preferred contact role
- Office address
- Response expectations
- Verified social links
- Privacy language
- Form recipient and internal process

Suggested working headlines

- Discuss your project.
- Tell us what you are working through.
- Start with a conversation.
- Not sure what the next step should be?
- What to expect after you contact CYNC.

Calls to action

Primary: Send your inquiry
Secondary: Email CYNC directly

Imagery direction

Use one restrained and relevant image, such as:

- Gordon or the team in a project setting
- The CYNC office environment
- A contextual Calgary image
- A project detail

The form and contact information should remain the priority.

Required client content

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- Approved contact details
- Form recipient
- Preferred response language
- Office information
- Social links
- Privacy statement
- Map preference
- Expected response timeframe

Mobile considerations

- Place contact methods near the top
- Make telephone and email links actionable
- Use a single-column form
- Use correct mobile input types
- Keep labels visible
- Provide clear validation and error messages
- Avoid placing the form over an image
- Confirm submission without removing entered information if an error occurs

18.9 Supporting Utility Pages

Utility pages do not require the same narrative depth as the primary pages, but they remain part of the complete experience.

Privacy Policy

Purpose: Explain how contact-form information, analytics, cookies, and other visitor data are handled.

Requirements:

- Accurate legal content
- Clear effective date
- Contact information
- Readable formatting
- Link in the footer and near the contact form

Accessibility

Purpose: Communicate CYNC's approach to digital accessibility and provide a way to report an issue.

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Requirements:

- Concise accessibility commitment
- Contact method for assistance
- Review date
- No unsupported compliance claims

Form Confirmation

Purpose: Confirm receipt and explain what happens next.

Working headline:

> Thank you. Your message has been received.

The confirmation should identify the expected next step without promising a response time CYNC cannot consistently maintain.

Page Not Found

Purpose: Help visitors recover from an incorrect or outdated link.

Working headline:

> This page could not be found.

Recommended actions:

- Return Home
- View Services
- Explore Projects
- Contact CYNC

Global page requirement

Every core page should contain:

- One clear purpose
- One primary message
- A visible relationship to CYNC's positioning
- Relevant and verified proof
- A clear next step
- Accessible navigation
- Responsive content hierarchy

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- Accurate page title and description
- Appropriate image text alternatives
- A consistent footer

The blueprint should now guide content collection and approval before the next Figma revision begins.

19. Project Story Content Standard

Purpose of This Standard

Project stories should demonstrate how CYNC understands complex situations, exercises professional judgment, coordinates responsibilities, and creates practical value for clients.

They should not function only as galleries of completed buildings. Photography remains important, but it should support a clear account of the client's situation, CYNC's role, the decisions made, and the outcome achieved.

Each project story should provide evidence of one or more of CYNC's brand pillars:

1. Clarity Before Design
2. Judgment Grounded in Experience
3. Accountable Leadership and Coordination
4. Practical Outcomes Built for the Long Term

This section establishes a reusable content framework for project stories. CYNC will be responsible for providing and approving the final project information, written content, supporting evidence, imagery, permissions, and credits. Novus will use representative content supplied by CYNC to establish the project-story structure and visual template within the agreed Figma designs.

The preparation, research, copywriting, and publication of every individual project story are not included in the current design engagement unless separately agreed.

19.1 Required Project Information

Before a project is presented publicly, CYNC should prepare and approve the following information:

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Information	Requirement
Project name	Confirm the official name and spelling
Client or owner	Confirm whether the organization may be identified
Location	Provide the appropriate public location
Project type	Identify the nature of the engagement, such as renovation, renewal, assessment, addition, or new construction
Organizational environment	Identify the relevant environment, such as municipal, educational, healthcare, institutional, industrial, or private development
Project status	Clearly identify whether the project is completed, in construction, in design, ongoing, or proposed
Project dates	Provide relevant design, construction, or completion dates
Project size	Provide the verified area or other appropriate measure, where relevant
Budget or construction value	Include only when verified and approved for publication

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CYNC’s role	Clearly identify CYNC’s contractual and professional role
CYNC’s services	List only the services CYNC actually provided
Consultant team	Identify participating firms and their respective disciplines
Contractor or construction manager	Include where relevant and approved
Project outcome	Describe the verified practical result or client value
Image and drawing credits	Identify the creator, owner, and approved source of each asset

Not every item must appear visibly on the published page. However, the relevant information should be confirmed before the project story is finalized.

19.2 Recommended Project Narrative

Each project story should follow a consistent narrative structure. The length may vary according to the significance of the project and the information available.

1. Client Situation

Explain what the client was facing and why the engagement was required.

This should begin with the client’s operational, organizational, technical, or facility-related need rather than immediately describing the architectural response.

2. Project Context

Provide the information a reader needs to understand the assignment, such as the facility type, existing conditions, users, location, operational environment, or broader program.

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3. Constraints and Considerations

Identify the conditions that made the project challenging or required particular care. These may include:

- Continued operation during construction
- Budget or schedule limitations
- Existing-building conditions
- Regulatory requirements
- Multiple stakeholders
- Technical coordination
- Accessibility requirements
- Public accountability
- Safety or security considerations
- Long-term maintenance requirements

4. What CYNC Needed to Understand

Describe the investigation, consultation, assessment, or coordination required before an appropriate response could be developed.

This section should make CYNC's process and judgment visible.

5. CYNC's Role and Responsibilities

State precisely what CYNC was responsible for, including its role as architect, Prime Consultant, project lead, advisor, or coordinating consultant where applicable.

The description should distinguish CYNC's work from the contributions of clients, consultants, contractors, and collaborating firms.

6. Important Decisions and Approach

Explain the significant decisions that shaped the project and why they mattered.

The focus should be on reasoning, priorities, coordination, and practical response rather than general promotional statements.

7. Outcome and Long-Term Value

Describe what was delivered and the value created for the client, building users, organization, or community.

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Only verified outcomes should be presented. Where a project is still underway, this section should describe the intended outcome without implying that it has already been achieved.

8. Supporting Evidence

Use relevant project facts, drawings, diagrams, photography, quotations, or measurable results to support the story.

Projects with limited completed photography can still be presented effectively when the available technical and contextual material demonstrates meaningful judgment and responsibility.

19.3 Project Status and Attribution

Accuracy in project status and attribution is essential to protecting CYNC's credibility.

Completed Projects

Completed projects may describe delivered outcomes when those outcomes have been verified and approved for publication.

Current Projects

Projects that remain in design, approvals, procurement, or construction should be clearly identified as current work. Proposed benefits should not be described as completed results.

Proposed Assignments

Proposal or qualification work should not be presented as an awarded or completed CYNC project. If referenced, it must be clearly described as a proposed assignment, relevant submission, or demonstration of approach.

CYNC Company Experience

Work presented as CYNC experience should accurately reflect CYNC's contractual role and responsibilities.

Individual Professional Experience

Projects completed by Gordon or another team member before joining or establishing CYNC may be relevant to the firm's capabilities, but they must be identified as individual prior experience rather than CYNC company experience.

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Collaborative Work

When projects involved another architectural firm, consultant, specialist, or delivery partner, the respective roles should be clearly and fairly described.

Consultant Contributions

CYNC should not claim responsibility for specialist work completed by another consultant. Where appropriate, project stories should recognize the disciplines and firms that contributed to the outcome.

19.4 Evidence and Imagery

Suitable supporting material may include:

- Completed project photography
- Existing-condition photography
- Construction-progress images
- Images showing the building in use
- Site plans, floor plans, and sections
- Technical details
- Process or coordination diagrams
- Before-and-after comparisons
- Verified project facts
- Approved client quotations
- Measurable outcomes
- Awards or formal recognition

All photographs, drawings, diagrams, and quotations should include appropriate credits where required. CYNC should confirm ownership, publication rights, client permissions, confidentiality requirements, and any restrictions before the materials are provided for public use.

19.5 Writing Principles

Project stories should be:

- Clear and specific
- Focused on the client’s situation
- Accurate about CYNC’s role
- Proportionate to the available evidence
- Understandable to non-technical readers
- Confident without exaggeration
- Consistent with CYNC’s approved tone of voice

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Technical information should be explained in plain language where possible. Claims such as improved performance, reduced cost, accelerated delivery, increased efficiency, or risk reduction should only be used when CYNC can verify and support them.

19.6 Content Responsibility

CYNC will provide:

- Final project facts and metadata
- Final written project descriptions
- Accurate role and service information
- Approved outcomes and statistics
- Consultant and collaborator information
- Photography, drawings, and diagrams
- Image credits and publication permissions
- Client approvals where required
- Final factual and publication approval

Within the current engagement, Novus will use the content and assets supplied by CYNC to establish a representative project-story design and reusable visual structure in Figma.

The following activities are outside the current engagement unless separately agreed:

- Researching individual projects
- Interviewing project participants
- Writing complete project stories
- Verifying technical or historical claims
- Securing client or third-party permissions
- Producing new photography, drawings, or diagrams
- Designing a unique layout for every project
- Populating project content within a developed website
- Creating and publishing future project pages

19.7 Publication Checklist

Before a project story is approved for publication, CYNC should confirm:

Project Information

- The project name and location are correct.
- The client or owner has been identified appropriately.
- The project type, dates, size, and status are accurate.
- Any budget or construction value is verified and approved.

Roles and Attribution

- CYNC's role is described accurately.
- CYNC's services are distinguished from the work of other consultants.
- Prior individual experience is not presented as CYNC company experience.
- Collaborating firms, consultants, contractors, and photographers are credited where required.

Narrative and Evidence

- The client situation and project context are understandable.
- Important constraints and decisions are supported by available information.
- Outcomes are verified and appropriate to the project's current status.
- Statistics, quotations, awards, and performance claims are approved.

Images and Permissions

- Images and drawings are of sufficient quality.
- Ownership and publication rights have been confirmed.
- Required image and drawing credits are included.
- Confidential, sensitive, or restricted information has been removed.
- Required client and third-party permissions have been obtained.

Final Approval

- The project story has received CYNC's factual approval.
- The project story has received CYNC's publication approval.
- The content is current as of the intended publication date.

Part V: Content and Design Revision

20. Content, Evidence and Asset Requirements

Purpose of This Section

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The approved brand strategy, website blueprint, and project-story framework establish how CYNC should present its business. To apply that direction accurately in Figma, Novus will require final content and approved visual assets from CYNC.

This section clarifies what CYNC will provide, how Novus will use those materials during the Figma revision, and which responsibilities remain outside the current engagement.

The objective is to ensure that the revised designs accurately reflect CYNC's business without transferring responsibility for factual content, project documentation, publication permissions, or comprehensive copywriting to Novus.

20.1 What CYNC Must Provide

CYNC will provide the final written content, project information, and visual assets required for the agreed website designs.

All materials supplied to Novus should be complete, accurate, approved for public use, and free from confidential or restricted information.

Company and Brand Content

CYNC will provide:

- Final company description
- Final service descriptions
- Approved statements about CYNC's experience and capabilities
- Gordon's biography, credentials, and professional history
- Team names, roles, biographies, credentials, and approved photographs
- Current contact information
- Office address and working hours, where applicable
- Approved social media and external links

The positioning, messaging framework, brand pillars, tone of voice, and working message examples within this document may be used by CYNC when preparing this content.

Project Content

CYNC will provide:

- The approved list of projects to be presented
- Final project names and locations
- Client or owner information
- Project types, dates, sizes, budgets, and status, where publishable

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- CYNC's precise role and services
- Project context, constraints, approach, and outcomes
- Consultant, contractor, and collaborator information
- Verified statistics and measurable claims
- Approved client quotations or testimonials
- Required attribution and credits

Project information should follow the standard established in Section 19.

Photography and Supporting Assets

CYNC will provide:

- Approved project photography
- Team photography
- Existing-condition and construction-progress images, where relevant
- Plans, sections, technical details, and diagrams selected for publication
- Logos or marks belonging to approved clients or collaborators, where applicable
- Photographer, illustrator, consultant, and asset credits
- Confirmation of ownership and publication rights
- Any required client or third-party permissions

Images should be supplied at the highest available quality and without embedded text, watermarks, or restrictive cropping wherever possible.

Administrative and Legal Content

CYNC will provide or approve:

- Final contact-form fields and recipient information
- Privacy-policy content
- Consent language required for website forms
- Any required legal notices or disclaimers
- Accessibility statements, where required
- Copyright information
- Final publication approval for all written and visual content

Novus is not responsible for providing legal advice or drafting legal policies. CYNC should obtain appropriate professional advice where necessary.

20.2 What Novus Will Use in the Figma Revision

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Novus will use the strategy approved through this document and the content supplied by CYNC to revise the agreed representative website designs in Figma.

The Figma revision will establish:

- Website hierarchy and navigation
- Page structure and section sequence
- Desktop and mobile presentation
- Typography and visual hierarchy
- Calls to action
- Reusable service modules
- Reusable project cards
- A representative project-story template
- Team and biography presentation
- Contact-page presentation
- Appropriate placement of imagery, drawings, diagrams, and supporting evidence
- Content patterns that remain effective when limited photography is available

Where approved final content is available, Novus will place that content into the relevant designs.

Where final content has not yet been supplied, Novus may use clearly identifiable working text, representative content, or placeholders to demonstrate layout, hierarchy, and approximate content length. Such material is included for design purposes only and should not be treated as final publication-ready copy.

Novus may make limited presentational adjustments where required to demonstrate the design, such as:

- Shortening a navigation label
- Dividing supplied content into sections
- Establishing heading hierarchy
- Correcting an obvious typographical error
- Indicating an appropriate approximate content length

These adjustments do not constitute comprehensive copywriting, technical editing, fact-checking, or final editorial approval.

The Figma work will establish reusable design patterns for the agreed core pages. It will not include a separately designed layout for every future project, article, team member, or content entry.

20.3 Verification and Publication Responsibilities

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CYNC retains responsibility for the accuracy, authorization, and final approval of all content associated with its business, people, clients, projects, and professional experience.

Area	Responsibility
Company facts and history	CYNC verifies and approves
Professional credentials	CYNC verifies and approves
Project facts and status	CYNC verifies and approves
CYNC's project role and services	CYNC verifies and approves
Individual versus company experience	CYNC confirms the correct attribution
Technical descriptions and claims	CYNC verifies and approves
Statistics and measurable outcomes	CYNC verifies and approves
Client names and testimonials	CYNC obtains the required approvals
Consultant and collaborator credits	CYNC confirms accurate attribution
Confidential or sensitive information	CYNC identifies and removes or restricts

Photography and drawing rights	CYNC confirms ownership and permission
Legal and privacy content	CYNC supplies or obtains professional advice
Visual presentation in Figma	Novus applies the approved design direction
Final content and publication approval	CYNC provides written approval

Novus will identify obvious inconsistencies or missing information when encountered during the design process. However, Novus will rely on CYNC's confirmation and will not independently audit project records, professional history, technical claims, legal requirements, or publication rights.

If final content or imagery is unavailable during the Figma revision, the affected design may be completed using representative material. Final content should be reviewed again by CYNC when it is later placed into the developed website.

20.4 Services Outside the Current Engagement

The current engagement is focused on brand and messaging direction, website experience planning, and the revision of agreed representative website designs in Figma.

Unless separately agreed in writing, the current engagement does not include:

- Comprehensive website copywriting
- Writing final page content
- Researching CYNC's company or project history
- Interviewing clients, consultants, employees, or project participants
- Writing individual project stories
- Writing Insights articles or other ongoing publications
- Creating biographies, technical descriptions, or detailed service content
- Independently fact-checking CYNC-supplied information
- Verifying professional, historical, technical, financial, or legal claims
- Securing client, photographer, consultant, or third-party permissions
- Producing photography or video

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- Creating new architectural drawings, illustrations, or technical diagrams
- Designing a unique page for every individual project or article
- Website development or programming
- Content management system configuration
- Content entry, migration, or website population
- Search engine optimization services
- Analytics, hosting, maintenance, or ongoing website support
- Legal, privacy, regulatory, or accessibility consulting
- Ongoing content strategy, editorial management, or publishing

Future projects and content entries should use the reusable structures established in the approved Figma design. Their implementation, population, and publication would occur as part of a later website-development engagement or another separately approved scope of work.

Any additional content, copywriting, asset-production, or website-development services may be considered separately if CYNC would like Novus to assist with those activities.

21. Figma Revision Brief

21.1 Purpose of the Figma Revision

The existing Figma work provides a useful visual and structural foundation for the CYNC website. It establishes a restrained palette, contemporary architectural character, desktop and mobile concepts, project presentation, service modules, team profiles, and common website components.

The purpose of the revision is not to discard the entire design or begin again. It is to realign the existing direction with the clarified brand strategy, messaging, website objectives, sitemap, and page hierarchy established in this document.

The revised Figma should communicate:

- What CYNC fundamentally provides
- Which client situations CYNC is equipped to address
- How CYNC applies experienced architectural judgment
- How CYNC leads and coordinates consultants and stakeholders
- Why direct principal involvement matters
- How CYNC helps clients make informed decisions
- How projects provide evidence of CYNC's capabilities
- Why CYNC's value cannot be communicated through project photography alone

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The revision should result in a more accurate and distinctive design direction while retaining the strongest elements of the initial work.

21.2 Retain, Revise, Replace, and Add

Retain

The following elements provide a suitable foundation and should continue to inform the revised design:

- The restrained and largely neutral colour palette
- The use of light and dark sections to create rhythm and contrast
- Contemporary architectural restraint
- Clean grid structures
- Generous use of whitespace
- Selected typography principles
- Existing navigation and footer foundations
- Responsive component foundations
- Team-card and biography structures
- Service-module foundations
- The use of large-scale imagery where the image is relevant and authentic
- The overall ambition to present CYNC as established, thoughtful, and design-conscious

These elements should be refined where necessary, but they do not require complete replacement.

Revise

The following areas should be revised to reflect the approved strategy:

- Homepage narrative and content hierarchy
- Navigation terminology
- Service organization and explanation
- Balance between display typography and practical readability
- Calls to action
- Project-card information
- Individual project-story structure
- About-page hierarchy
- Visibility of Gordon’s leadership and direct involvement
- Presentation of CYNC’s Prime Consultant role
- Use of image overlays
- Mobile content density
- Contact-page clarity

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- Footer content and hierarchy

The central revision should move the experience from a visually led architecture portfolio toward a confidence-led presentation of CYNC's judgment, leadership, process, and evidence.

Replace

The following elements should be removed or replaced:

- Positioning language that does not accurately represent CYNC
- Luxury-residential emphasis
- Generic promotional statements
- Grandiose or theatrical brand language
- Unverified project descriptions, statistics, or outcomes
- Placeholder project information that could be mistaken for fact
- Generic project stories that focus only on appearance
- Layouts that depend on extensive high-end photography
- Imagery that does not represent CYNC's actual work or client environments
- Content labels that do not reflect the approved sitemap
- References to Blog or Studio Journal unless an Insights section is approved for a future phase

Representative placeholder content may still be used where necessary to demonstrate a layout, but it should be clearly identified as working content and should not be presented as approved CYNC information.

Add

The revised design should introduce or strengthen:

- Messaging based on the client's situation
- Clear explanations of how CYNC helps
- CYNC's architectural and Prime Consultant responsibilities
- Direct principal involvement
- Project role and status labels
- Evidence-based project information
- Relevant technical and contextual imagery
- Opportunities to show process, coordination, and decision-making
- Layouts that remain effective when project photography is limited
- Clear service relationships
- More direct and useful calls to action
- Accessible typography and interaction patterns
- Mobile layouts based on deliberate content prioritization

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Diagrams or technical visuals should only be included where appropriate source material is available or where the design can establish a reusable placeholder for future implementation. The current engagement does not require Novus to produce new technical, architectural, or project-specific diagrams.

21.3 Representative Pages and Templates

The Figma revision will focus on the core pages and reusable design patterns required to establish the intended website experience.

Design Item	Figma Revision
Global navigation	One consistent navigation system with appropriate desktop and mobile treatment
Footer	One reusable footer system
Home	Revised to lead with CYNC's value, relevant client situations, approach, services, evidence, and clear next steps
Services	One consolidated Services page showing CYNC's capabilities and how they relate
Projects	One Projects index design using representative project categories, cards, and verified information where available
Individual Project Story	One reusable representative template demonstrating the approved project-story structure

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About	Revised to communicate CYNC's history, leadership, operating principles, experience, and team
Contact	Revised to support clear, qualified enquiries
Insights	Future consideration only. The strategic framework is included in this document, but these pages are not included in the current Figma revision.
Individual Insight	Future consideration only. The strategic framework is included in this document, but these pages are not included in the current Figma revision.

The representative project-story template will establish how future projects should be presented. It does not require Novus to create a separate Figma design for every CYNC project.

The consolidated Services design will establish the presentation of CYNC's approved services. It does not include an individual page or unique design for every service.

If an Insights section is introduced in the future, its listing page, article template, content requirements, and implementation should be addressed as part of a future engagement.

21.4 Desktop and Mobile Implications

The desktop and mobile designs should express the same brand strategy, messaging priorities, and visual system. Navigation, typography, colour, calls to action, project information, and core content modules should remain consistent across screen sizes.

Mobile designs should not simply compress the desktop layouts. They should prioritize the information visitors are most likely to need and place it in a clear, readable sequence.

Mobile revision priorities include:

- Immediate communication of CYNC's value
- Clear and accessible navigation
- Readable typography
- Reduced dependence on large display treatments

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- Shorter visible introductions where appropriate
- Clear service and project labels
- Accessible calls to action
- Appropriate image crops
- Reduced overlay density
- Logical stacking of project facts
- Simplified evidence and process modules
- Removal of decorative elements that interfere with comprehension
- Suitable spacing and touch-target sizing

The revised Figma will demonstrate the intended responsive direction through the agreed representative pages and components. It is not intended to document every possible screen size, interaction state, content variation, or future CMS entry.

Detailed responsive behaviour, browser-specific implementation, animation, CMS behaviour, and technical interaction states will be addressed during a future website-development engagement.

21.5 Content Dependencies and Scope Boundaries

The quality and accuracy of the revised designs will depend on CYNC providing the content and assets identified in Section 20.

The most important design dependencies include:

- Approved company and positioning language
- Final service names and descriptions
- Approved project list
- Verified project facts
- Accurate project roles and status
- Gordon’s approved biography and credentials
- Current team information
- Approved project and team imagery
- Photographer and consultant credits
- Confirmed contact information
- Client and third-party publication permissions

Where final content is not available, Novus may use representative text, sample content, or placeholders to complete the agreed design direction. These materials will demonstrate hierarchy, layout, and approximate content requirements only.

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If CYNC later supplies content that differs substantially in length, structure, purpose, or volume from the representative content used in Figma, corresponding design changes may need to be addressed during website development or through a separately approved revision.

The current Figma revision includes:

- Application of the approved brand and messaging direction
- Revision of the agreed core-page designs
- Establishment of reusable page and content patterns
- Representative desktop and mobile direction
- One consolidated Services-page design
- One Projects-index design
- One reusable Individual Project Story template
- Revised About and Contact designs
- Organization and handoff of the agreed Figma design work

The current Figma revision does not include:

- A unique design for every project
- A unique design for every service
- Separate sector pages
- Individual Insights articles
- Ongoing additions to the Figma file
- Final website copywriting
- Project research or project-story writing
- Photography or video production
- Creation of project-specific technical drawings or diagrams
- Website development
- CMS selection or configuration
- Content entry or migration
- Population of project or Insights pages
- Hosting, deployment, analytics, or maintenance
- Ongoing publishing or website administration

Future website pages and content entries should use the reusable structures established through the approved Figma direction. Their development, population, publication, and ongoing management will form part of a later engagement or remain CYNC's responsibility, depending on the scope agreed at that time.

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